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Rotary fibrous material application to medical devices

Abstract

A method of applying fibrous material to a medical device component involves coupling a medical device component a holder device, rotating a reservoir device containing a liquid polymeric solution to expel at least a portion of the liquid polymeric solution from an orifice of the reservoir device, the expelled at least a portion of the liquid polymeric solution forming one or more strands of fibrous material in a deposition plane, and rotating the holder device at least partially within the deposition plane to apply at least a first portion of the one or more strands of fibrous material to one or more surfaces of the medical device component, thereby forming a fibrous covering on the one or more surfaces of the medical device component.

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Background/Summary

RELATED APPLICATION (1) This application is a continuation of International Patent Application No. PCT/US2020/044412, filed on Jul. 31, 2020, which claims the benefit of U.S. Patent Application No. 62/882,352, filed on Aug. 2, 2019, the entire disclosures all of which are incorporated by reference for all purposes.

BACKGROUND

Field

(1) The present disclosure generally relates to the field of medical implant devices.

Description of Related Art

(2) Various medical devices include component(s) having cloth or other fibrous features. Manufacturing of such devices according to various application processes can be cumbersome. Furthermore, material characteristics of such cloths/fibrous features can affect the efficacy of associated medical devices.

SUMMARY

(3) Described herein are methods and devices that facilitate application of fibrous material and/or features to medical devices. In some implementations, the present disclosure relates to a method of applying fibrous material to a medical device component. The method comprises coupling a medical device component a holder device, rotating a reservoir device containing a liquid polymeric solution to expel at least a portion of the liquid polymeric solution from an orifice of the reservoir device, the expelled at least a portion of the liquid polymeric solution forming one or more strands of fibrous material in a deposition plane, and rotating the holder device at least partially within the deposition plane to apply at least a first portion of the one or more strands of fibrous material to one or more surfaces of the medical device component, thereby forming a fibrous covering on the one or more surfaces of the medical device component.

(4) In some embodiments, the holder device is a component of a collection assembly further comprising a rotary motor and a mandrel that is mechanically coupled to the holder device and the rotary motor. For example, the method may further comprise translating the collection assembly along a vertical axis while expelling the at least a portion of the liquid polymeric solution.

(5) The holder device can advantageously have an at least partially cylindrical spacer form. For example, the method may further comprise applying at least a second portion of the one or more strands of fibrous material to a surface of the holder device, thereby forming a surplus fibrous covering portion on the surface of the holder device. The method may further comprise decoupling the medical device component from the holder device and folding the surplus fibrous covering

portion over at least one edge of the medical device component to cover at least a portion of an inside surface of the medical device component. As an alternative to folding the surplus material, the mandrel can be coated first, with the stent subsequently mounted, after which the outer skirt can be coated. Once complete, the sandwiched stent and fibrous material can be withdrawn from the holder. In some implementations, a laser (e.g., CO.sub.2 laser) can be used to cut out/off any excess fibrous material.

(6) In some implementations, wherein the holder device comprises a plurality of arms configured to be coupled to the medical device component. For example, coupling the medical device component to the holder device can comprise suturing the medical device component to the plurality of arms of the holder device. In some implementations, rotating the reservoir device and the holder device is performed at least in part using control circuitry communicatively coupled to a collection assembly associated with the holder device and a deposition assembly associated with the reservoir device.

(7) In some implementations, the medical device component comprises a stent of a transcatheter prosthetic heart valve implant device, the holder device comprises an at least partially cylindrical spacer form, and coupling the medical device component to the holder involves disposing the stent about the spacer form. For example, the stent can have a non-uniform longitudinal diameter. In some implementations, the medical device component comprises a frame of a surgical prosthetic heart valve implant device, the holder device comprises a plurality of arms, and coupling the medical device component to the holder involves coupling the frame to the plurality of arms. For example, the frame can comprise a wireform defining a plurality of commissure posts and an anchoring skirt coupled to a sealing ring portion of the surgical prosthetic heart valve implant device.

(8) The method can further comprise applying at least a second portion of the one or more strands of fibrous material to the anchoring skirt to form a skirt covering, wherein the skirt covering is coarser than the fibrous covering. For example, in some embodiments, the frame comprises a body portion and an anchor feature portion and applying the at least a first portion of the one or more strands of fibrous material to the one or more surfaces of the medical device component involves covering at least a portion of the anchor feature portion of the frame with fibrous material.

Covering the at least a portion of the anchor feature portion may be performed when the anchor feature portion is in a straightened-out configuration.

(9) In some embodiments, the medical device component comprises a valve leaflet spacer device. For example, rotating the holder device may be performed with the valve leaflet spacer device configured in an at least partially straightened-out configuration, wherein the method further comprises transitioning the valve leaflet spacer device from the at least partially straightened-out configuration to a folded configuration after said forming the fibrous covering on the one or more surfaces of the medical device component.

(10) In some implementations, the present disclosure relates to a method of applying fibrous material to a medical device component. The method comprises coupling a holder device to a rotatable mandrel, the holder device comprising a spacer form, rotating a reservoir device containing a liquid polymeric solution to expel at least a portion of the liquid polymeric solution from an orifice of the reservoir device, the expelled at least a portion of the liquid polymeric solution forming one or more strands of fibrous material in a deposition plane, rotating the holder device at least partially within the deposition plane to apply at least a first portion of the one or more strands of fibrous material to a surface of the holder device, thereby forming a fibrous covering on the surface of the holder device, and disposing a medical device component on the holder device over the fibrous covering.

(11) The method may further comprise applying a layer of fibrous material from the reservoir over at least a portion of an outer surface of the medical device component and withdrawing the medical device component together with the fibrous covering and the layer of fibrous material from the holder device. As an alternative to folding the surplus material, the mandrel can be coated first,

with the stent subsequently mounted, after which the outer skirt can be coated. Once complete, the sandwiched stent and fibrous material can be withdrawn from the holder. In some implementations, a laser (e.g., CO.sub.2 laser) can be used to cut out/off any excess fibrous material. The method may further comprise folding a portion of the fibrous covering over an outer surface of the medical device component. In some embodiments, the spacer form is cylindrical.

(12) For purposes of summarizing the disclosure, certain aspects, advantages and novel features are described herein. It is to be understood that not necessarily all such advantages may be achieved in accordance with any particular embodiment. Thus, the disclosed embodiments may be carried out in a manner that achieves or optimizes one advantage or group of advantages as taught herein without necessarily achieving other advantages as may be taught or suggested herein.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) Various embodiments are depicted in the accompanying drawings for illustrative purposes and should in no way be interpreted as limiting the scope of the inventions. In addition, various features of different disclosed embodiments can be combined to form additional embodiments, which are part of this disclosure. Throughout the drawings, reference numbers may be reused to indicate correspondence between reference elements. However, it should be understood that the use of similar reference numbers in connection with multiple drawings does not necessarily imply similarity between respective embodiments associated therewith. Furthermore, it should be understood that the features of the respective drawings are not necessarily drawn to scale, and the illustrated sizes thereof are presented for the purpose of illustration of inventive aspects thereof. Generally, certain of the illustrated features may be relatively smaller than as illustrated in some embodiments or configurations.

(2) FIG. 1 shows a frame for a support stent for a surgical heart valve in accordance with one or more embodiments.

(3) FIG. 2 illustrates the frame of FIG. 1 covered at least partially with fabric in accordance with one or more embodiments.

(4) FIGS. 3 and 4 shown another example assembly of an at least partially cloth-covered prosthetic heart valve implant device in accordance with one or more embodiments.

(5) FIG. 5 illustrates an operator performing operations on a prosthetic human implant device in accordance with one or more embodiments.

(6) FIG. 6 illustrates a close-up view of a prosthetic implant device having a cloth/fabric component placed thereon and sutured using manual holding and suturing in accordance with one or more embodiments.

(7) FIG. 7 shows an electrospinning system for applying fibrous material to a medical implant device component in accordance with one or more embodiments.

(8) FIG. 8A shows a rotary jet spinning system for applying a fibrous material to a medical implant device component in accordance with one or more embodiments.

(9) FIG. 8B is close-up view of a reservoir component of the system shown in FIG. 8A in accordance with one or more embodiments.

(10) FIGS. 9 and 10 show side views of examples of collection assemblies comprising spacer-type and arm-type holders, respectively, in accordance with one or more embodiments.

(11) FIG. 11 illustrates an example stent that may be used in a prosthetic heart valve implant device in accordance with one or more embodiments.

(12) FIG. 12 shows a stent disposed about a spacer-form holder in accordance with one or more embodiments.

(13) FIG. 13 shows a stent disposed about a holder and covered at least partially with fibrous

material using a rotary jet spinning deposition system in accordance with one or more embodiments.

(14) FIG. 14 illustrates a frame incorporated in an implantable prosthetic valve in accordance with one or more embodiments.

(15) FIG. 15 shows an example heart valve implant device including a stent that has fibrous material applied to one or more portions thereof using a rotary jet spinning process in accordance with one or more embodiments.

(16) FIG. 16 shows an example of a heart valve implant device having non-uniform stent diameter that has fibrous material applied to one or more portions thereof using a rotary jet spinning process in accordance with one or more embodiments.

(17) FIG. 17 is a perspective view of a prosthetic heart valve implant device in accordance with one or more embodiments.

(18) FIG. 18 shows a heart valve assembly disposed on a holder in accordance with one or more embodiments.

(19) FIG. 19 shows a surgical heart valve having fibrous material applied to portions thereof using rotary jet spinning in accordance with one or more embodiments.

(20) FIG. 20 is a side view of a prosthetic spacer device in accordance with one or more embodiments.

(21) FIG. 21 shows a spacer device disposed on a holder in accordance with one or more embodiments.

(22) FIG. 22 shows a spacer device having fibrous material applied to portions thereof using rotary jet spinning in accordance with one or more embodiments.

(23) FIG. 23 shows a prosthetic heart valve device that can be covered at least in part by fibrous material using rotary jet spinning in accordance with one or more embodiments.

(24) FIG. 24 shows a heart valve frame disposed on a holder in accordance with one or more embodiments.

(25) FIG. 25 shows a heart valve device having fibrous material applied to portions thereof using rotary jet spinning in accordance with one or more embodiments.

(26) FIG. 26 is a perspective view of an annuloplasty repair device in accordance with one or more embodiments.

(27) FIG. 27 shows an annuloplasty repair device disposed on a holder in accordance with one or more embodiments.

(28) FIG. 28 shows a perspective view of an annuloplasty repair device having fibrous material applied thereto using rotary jet spinning in accordance with one or more embodiments.

(29) FIG. 29 is a perspective view of a frames for a docking device in accordance with one or more embodiments of the present disclosure.

(30) FIG. 30 shows the docking device frame disposed on a holder in accordance with one or more embodiments.

(31) FIG. 31 shows a perspective view of a docking device having fibrous material applied to at least a portion thereof in accordance with embodiments of the present disclosure.

(32) FIG. 32 shows an example type of docking device that can be covered at least in part by fibrous material using rotary jet spinning solutions in accordance with one or more embodiments.

(33) FIG. 33 shows a docking device frame disposed on a holder in accordance with one or more embodiments.

(34) FIG. 34 shows a docking device having fibrous material applied to portions thereof using rotary jet spinning in accordance with one or more embodiments.

(35) FIG. 35 shows a docking device that can be covered at least in part by fibrous material using rotary jet spinning solutions in accordance with one or more embodiments.

(36) FIG. 36 shows a valved conduit assembly in accordance with one or more embodiments.

(37) FIG. 37 illustrates a septal closure device having fibrous material applied to one or more

portions thereof using rotary jet spinning in accordance with one or more embodiments.

(38) FIG. **38** illustrates a docking device having fibrous material applied to one or more portions thereof using rotary jet spinning in accordance with one or more embodiments.

(39) FIG. **39** illustrates a tissue anchor device having fibrous material applied to one or more portions thereof using rotary jet spinning in accordance with one or more embodiments.

(40) FIG. **40** illustrates an annuloplasty repair device having fibrous material applied to one or more portions thereof using rotary jet spinning in accordance with one or more embodiments.

(41) FIG. **41** is a flow diagram for a process for applying fibrous material to a medical device component in accordance with one or more embodiments.

(42) To further clarify various aspects of embodiments of the present disclosure, a more particular description of certain embodiments will be made by reference to various aspects of the appended drawings. It is appreciated that these drawings depict only typical embodiments of the present disclosure and are therefore not to be considered limiting of the scope of the disclosure. Moreover, while the figures can be drawn to scale for some embodiments, the figures are not necessarily drawn to scale for all embodiments. Embodiments of the present disclosure will be described and explained with additional specificity and detail through the use of the accompanying drawings.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(43) Embodiments of the technology disclosed herein are directed toward methods for methods and devices that facilitate application of fibrous material/features to medical devices. More particularly, various embodiments of the technology disclosed herein relate to methods for applying rotary-jet-spun fibrous material to one or more surfaces of a medical device, such as a wireform frame or stent.

(44) Various medical devices include components that are advantageously covered at least in part by cloth or other fibrous material. The terms “fiber” and “fibrous material” are used herein according to their broad and ordinary meanings and may refer to any type of natural or synthetic substance or material that is significantly longer than it is wide, including any elongate or relatively fine, slender, and/or threadlike piece, filament, cord, yarn, plie, strand, line, string, or portion thereof. Furthermore, “fiber” or “fibrous material” may refer to a single filament or collectively to a plurality of filaments. Examples of fibrous material in accordance with embodiments of the present disclosure include any type of cloth, fabric, or textile. While certain description below refers to “cloth” and/or “cloth-covered” features, it should be understood that such description is applicable to any type of fibrous material, including any type of cloth, fabric, textile, or interlocking-fiber material or form.

(45) Examples of medical device components that may be covered or otherwise associated with cloth or other fibrous material include certain stents, which may generally comprise a conduit form configured to be placed in a body to create or maintain a passageway within the body, or to provide a relatively stable anchoring structure for supporting one or more other devices or anatomy. At least partially cloth-covered stents can be used for a variety of purposes, such as for expansion of certain vessels, including blood vessels, ducts, or other conduits, whether vascular, coronary, biliary, or other type. In the context of a prosthetic heart valve devices, a stent can serve as a structural component for anchoring the prosthetic heart valve to the tissue of a heart valve annulus. Such a stent can have varying shapes and/or diameters.

(46) It should be understood that prosthetic heart valve implants, as well as many other types of prosthetic implant devices and other types of devices, can include various cloth-covered components and/or portions. For example, a sealing portion of a medical implant device, such as a prosthetic heart valve skirt component/portion, can be sutured to a frame thereof to help prevent blood from leaking around the outer edges or circumference of the device.

(47) In some implementations, cloth coverings for medical device components can be secured using sutures. For example, in some implementations, a human operator may handle, and execute sutures on, implant device components to secure a cloth thereto. However, execution of sutures by

a human operator may be relatively difficult and/or cumbersome in certain situations. For example, where small stitches are to be made with relatively high precision, the complexity and/or associated operator burden may result in injury/strain and/or undesirably-low product quality. Furthermore, medical implant devices, such as certain heart valve implant devices, may require upward of a thousand sutures, or more, which can involve substantially labor-intensive and error-susceptible suturing procedures. Therefore, reducing the collaborative human involvement in application of fibrous material to medical device components can be desirable to improve quality and efficiency, and/or to reduce operator strain.

(48) Certain embodiments disclosed herein provide for application of fibrous material to medical implant device component(s) using rotary jet spinning devices, systems, processes, and mechanisms. The various embodiments relating to rotary jet fabric application are applicable to medical implant devices and heart valves having any type of structural configuration or pattern. Examples of medical implant devices and heart valve structures that may be applicable to certain embodiments presented herein are disclosed in International Patent Publication No. WO 2015/070249, the entire contents of which is hereby expressly incorporated by reference for all purposes.

(49) Some example medical implant devices incorporating cloth coverings comprise prosthetic heart valve implants incorporating cloth-covered bands and/or wireframes, which may provide sealing, structural support, and/or anchoring functionality. FIG. 1 shows a frame 92 for a support stent for a surgical heart valve according to some embodiments. The frame 92 can include multiple cusps curved toward an axial inflow end alternating with multiple commissures 22 projecting toward an axial outflow end, the support stent 92 defining an undulating outflow edge. The support stent 92 can comprise a wireform 20 having three upstanding commissures 22 alternating with three cusps 24 which generally circumscribe a circumference. A stiffening band 26 may be disposed within or without the wireform 20. The inflow edge of the band 26 can at least partially conform to the cusps 24 of the wireform 20 and may be curved in the outflow direction in between in the region of the wireform commissures 22. In certain embodiments, the support stent 92 provides the supporting structure of a one-way surgical prosthetic heart valve, as disclosed in greater detail in connection with some embodiments described below.

(50) FIG. 2 illustrates the frame 92 of FIG. 1 covered with fabric 40, wherein the fabric 40 may be sutured in one or more portions to secure the fabric 40 as a covering for the frame 92. The fabric-covered support stent 42 may be generally tubular and may include multiple cusps 44 curved toward the axial inflow end alternating with multiple commissures 46 projecting toward the axial outflow end. The support stent 42 may comprise an undulating outflow edge about which the fabric 40 is secured or held. In certain embodiments, a seam 50 may be sutured adjacent the inflow edge 52 that secures the fabric 40 about the support stent. The seam 50 is shown slightly axially above the inflow edge 52 for clarity, although it may be located directly at the inflow edge or even inside the support stent. In one embodiment, one or more seams may be located in other positions on the fabric. The support stent 42 and/or one or more other components of the associated implant device can also have leaflets and/or other materials sutured thereto, as described in detail below.

(51) FIGS. 3 and 4 show an exploded view of another example assembly of an at least partially cloth-covered prosthetic heart valve implant device, which is presented to provide additional context relating to incorporation of cloth/fabric coverings in medical implant devices. In particular, the example of FIGS. 3 and 4 may generally relate to a valve implant device having an associated fabric-covered anchoring skirt 26. For example, a self-expanding stent or balloon-expanding stent may be used as part of a prosthetic heart valve having a single-stage implantation in which a surgeon secures a hybrid heart valve having an anchoring skirt and valve member to a heart valve annulus as one unit or piece. Some related solutions especially for aortic valve replacement are provided in U.S. Pat. No. 8,641,757, the disclosure of which is incorporated herein by reference in its entirety for all purposes. In some implementations, an implantation process associated with the

assembly of FIGS. 3 and 4 may require as few as three sutures, unlike more time-consuming processes requiring placement of a dozen or more sutures and tying knots for each of a plurality of components/portions of the assembly.

(52) The valve implant assembly of FIGS. 3 and 4 may incorporate a valve frame, which may be similar in one or more respects to the frame shown in FIGS. 1 and 2 and described above. The anchoring skirt 26 may include an inner plastically-expandable stent covered with a fabric, for example, a polymeric fabric. The anchoring skirt 26 may comprise an inner stent frame 80, a fabric covering 82, and a band-like lower sealing flange 84. The inner stent frame 80 may comprise a tubular plastically-expandable member having an undulating or scalloped upper end 86 that matches the contours of an inflow portion of the heart valve.

(53) In some implementations, the fabric 82 may be sewn to the stent frame 80. For example, the tubular section of fabric 82 may be drawn taut around the stent frame 80, inside and/or outside, and sewn thereto to form an intermediate, cloth-covered frame 88. After surrounding the stent frame 80 with the fabric 82, a series of longitudinal sutures can be implemented to secure the two components together. Furthermore, a series of stitches may be implemented along the undulating upper end 86 of the stent frame 80 to complete the fabric enclosure.

(54) Generally, the cloth/fabric 82 attached to the stent 80 can serve to reduce friction between the stent and the relevant body orifice, to secure the prosthetic heart valve in the orifice location, to fill gaps through which fluid could pass through, and/or to provide a location for tissue in-growth. Applying and sewing the cloth 82, however, can be a relatively time-consuming and laborious process.

(55) In addition to the cloth/fabric components illustrated in FIGS. 1-4, medical device implant devices can include various other cloth-covered and/or sutured components and/or portions. Application of fibrous material to medical device component(s) by a human operator can be relatively difficult and/or cumbersome in certain implementations. For example, where small stitches are to be made with relatively high precision, the complexity and/or associated operator burden may result in injury and/or undesirably low quality of products. Furthermore, certain heart valve implant devices may require upward of a thousand sutures, which can involve substantially labor-intensive and error-susceptible suturing procedures. Therefore, simplification of the application of cloth/fabric to medical device implants can potentially improve quality and/or reduce operator involvement, such as requiring less handling to position and/or hold cloth/fabric portions in place for suturing.

(56) Generally, application of cloth to medical implant devices may be performed in various ways. For example, certain handheld processes for applying and suturing fibrous material to prosthetic human implant devices may be implemented in which an operator utilizes both hands for holding, securing, and/or suturing the cloth/fabric portions of the implant device. As an example, FIG. 5 illustrates an operator 405 performing operations on a prosthetic human implant device 410. In some implementations, an operator 405 may hold and/or suture an outer wireframe of a device 410 to an inner skirt or cloth, as described above. In the example of FIG. 5, the implant device 410 may be a transcatheter heart valve device or other implant device.

(57) As illustrated in the diagram of FIG. 5, in some processes, an operator 405 may need to utilize both of his or her hands for attaching fibrous material/cloth to a medical implant device. For example, a first hand 406 may be used to hold and/or secure the cloth/fabric to the implant device 410 in the desired position, whereas a second hand 407 may be used to manually operate a suturing needle or the like. Furthermore, for the operator 405 to effectively execute the relevant fabric-application operations, it may be necessary or desirable for the view of the implant device 410 to be magnified or otherwise enhanced in some manner. For example, as shown, the operator 405 may further utilize a magnification system 460, such as a microscope, which may comprise an eyepiece component 461 as well as one or more lenses and/or refractive elements 463. In certain embodiments, the magnification system 460 may be designed such that the operator 405 may have

a line of sight **409** at a first angle, wherein the magnification system **460** is configured to at least partially reflect light therein at a downward angle **408** to provide a depth of field at a targeted distance from the refractive elements **463**. By holding the implant device **410**, or target portion thereof, within the depth of field of the magnification system **460**, the operator **405** may be able to observe an enhanced view of the implant device **410** or target portion thereof, which may be desirable or necessary to execute the precise fabric application and/or suturing operations.

(58) FIG. **6** illustrates a close-up view of a prosthetic implant device **440** having a cloth/fabric component placed thereon and sutured using manual holding and suturing, as described above. As shown, for handheld suturing solutions, a first hand **406** may be required to hold the cloth/fabric component in place on the implant device **440**, while a second hand **507** may be required to manipulate the suturing needle **409**, or the like. According to certain processes, the operator may be required to hold one or more hands in a substantially constant position over prolonged periods of time to maintain the cloth/fabric portion in the desired position while suturing is performed, which may require the operator to squeeze, push, pull, or otherwise exert manual force on one or more portions of the implant device **510**, thereby causing strain on muscles, joints, or the like, of the operator's hands and/or other anatomy. The implant device **440** may be supported on a holder **401** in some implementations. In some implementations, handheld holders and tools may require operators to hold the holder or tool with one hand, thereby limiting the ability of the operator to use such holding hand to adjust the cloth/fabric component(s) for tensioning and/or realignment.

(59) In some implementations, the present disclosure relates to systems, devices, and methods of applying fibrous material to surfaces of a medical implant device, such as a stent or the like, in a way that reduces labor time and production costs. Embodiments disclosed herein satisfy this need and other needs.

(60) In some implementations, fibrous material may be applied to a medical implant device using an electrospinning process. For example, with respect to certain prosthetic heart valve implant devices, fibrous material may be applied to a metal stent structure, wherein the applied fibrous material may serve to reduce friction between the stent and certain anatomy (e.g., vessel/orifice) at the implantation site, to secure the implant device at the implantation site, to fill gaps through which fluid may pass, and/or to provide a surface for tissue in-growth.

(61) Polymeric fibers, such as nanofibers, may have desirable utility for medical implant device coverings due to their high surface-to-mass ratio, high porosity, tissue in-growth properties, and because they can be easily wound into different shapes. Electrospinning represents one method for producing such nanofibers. Electrospinning processes generally employ high voltages to create an electric field between a droplet of polymer solution at the tip of a needle and a collector plate, as described in detail below. One electrode of the voltage source is placed into the solution and the other is connected to the collector. This creates an electrostatic force. As the voltage is increased, the electric field intensifies causing a force to build up on the pendant drop of polymer solution at the tip of the needle. This force acts in a direction opposing the surface tension of the drop. The increasing electrostatic force causes the drop to elongate forming a conical shape. When the electrostatic force overcomes the surface tension of the drop, a charged, continuous jet of solution is ejected from the cone. The jet of solution accelerates towards the collector, whipping and bending wildly. As the solution moves away from the needle and toward the collector, the jet rapidly thins and dries as the solvent evaporates. On the surface of the grounded collector, a nonwoven mat of randomly oriented solid nanofibers is deposited.

(62) For certain cloth-application processes, as described in detail above, applying and suturing the cloth can be a time-consuming and laborious process. Electrospinning application of fibrous material represents one example of an alternative method of applying a fabric or fibrous material (e.g., polymeric fibrous material) to surfaces of a stent or other medical implant device component in a way that can reduce labor time and production costs. By way of illustration, electrospun polymeric material may be applied to a medical device implant (e.g., metal stent) while the implant

and a supporting mandrel/holder are rotated by a rotary tool. Over time, the electrospinning process produces a layer of polymeric threads or fibers covering the outside of the target surface. Certain methods, devices, and systems relating to electrospinning concepts that may be applicable to embodiments of the present disclosure are disclosed in U.S. Publication No. 2017/0325976, the disclosure of which is hereby incorporated by reference in its entirety for all purposes.

(63) FIG. 7 shows a system **100** for applying an electrospinning material **102** to a stent or other medical implant device component **104**. The system **100** comprises a source of electrospinning material **106**, a collector **108**, and a controller **110**. The source of electrospinning material is any suitable device, for example, a device comprising a spinneret electrically coupled to a voltage source. The source may comprise, for example, one or more syringe pumps, one or more syringes mounted on the syringe pump(s), and one or more syringe needles fluidly coupled to the syringe(s). In some embodiments, the spinneret-type syringe(s) are implemented. In some embodiments, a voltage source is electrically coupled to the syringe needle(s).

(64) In some embodiments, the electrospinning material **102** is a solution of polyethylene terephthalate (PET). The PET solution may be created by mixing PET (e.g., at about 10% to 20% by weight) with a suitable solvent or mixture of solvents (e.g., hexafluoroisopropanol (HFIP) at about 80% to 90% by weight) and permitting the PET to dissolve fully. In a particular embodiment, the PET solution is created by mixing PET at about 15% to 18% by weight with a solvent such as HFIP at about 82% to 85% by weight. Instead of or in addition to PET, another polymer may be used, either alone or in combination, such as a polymer selected from the group consisting of polytetrafluoroethylene (PTFE), polycaprolactone (PCL), polydioxanone (PDO), polyglycolic acid (PGA), and polyurethane (PU). Additionally, one or more drugs and/or biologically active ingredients may be added to the solution. Similarly, other solvents or mixtures thereof are used in other embodiments.

(65) In some embodiments, the medical device implant **104** comprises a stent for use as part of a prosthetic heart valve, such as the Edwards Intuity® valve system disclosed in U.S. Pat. No. 8,641,757 to Pintor et al. or the Edwards SAPIEN® transcatheter heart valve. The stent **104** may be an expandable stainless-steel stent. The material, however, is not limited to stainless steel, and other materials such as cobalt-chrome alloys and nitinol may be used.

(66) The syringe pump **106** serves as the source of the electrospinning material **102** to be applied to the stent **104**. Some embodiments include a plurality of syringe pumps. In general, electrospinning uses an electrical charge to draw very fine (typically on the micro- or nanometer scale) fibers from a liquid, such as a polymer solution or a polymer melt. In some implementations, the polymer is discharged through a charged orifice toward a target, wherein the orifice and the target have opposing electrical charges. A voltage source is provided that creates a first charge at the charged orifice and an opposing charge at the target. The polymer is electrostatically charged by contact with the charged orifice. The electrostatically charged polymer is then collected at the target. Electrospinning PTFE is described in U.S. Patent Publication No. 2010/0193999, which is incorporated herein by reference for all purposes.

(67) The syringe pump **106** may be used with a syringe, which may generally comprise a cylindrical body defining a reservoir into which an amount of the electrospinning material **102** is placed. After the reservoir is filled, the syringe may be placed on a syringe holder block of the syringe pump **106**. Once the syringe pump **106** is fitted with a loaded syringe, the orifice of the syringe may be connected to a tube that is coupled to a spinneret comprising a, e.g., stainless-steel needle. The electrospinning material **102** can be electrostatically drawn from the spinneret tip by applying a relatively high voltage or potential difference between the spinneret tip and the collector **108** using a high-voltage power supply **130** connected by wires **132** to the spinneret and the collector **108**. In some embodiments, the high-voltage power supply **130** provides a direct-current (DC) power supply of about 5 kV to 50 kV.

(68) In some implementations, fibrous material may be applied to a medical implant device using a

rotary jet spinning process. For example, with respect to certain prosthetic heart valve implant devices, fibrous material may be applied to a metal stent structure, wherein the applied fibrous material may serve to reduce friction between the stent and certain anatomy (e.g., vessel/orifice) at the implantation site, to secure the implant device at the implantation site, to fill gaps through which fluid may pass, and/or to provide a surface for tissue in-growth. For certain cloth-application processes, as described in detail above, applying and suturing the cloth can be a time-consuming and laborious process. Rotary jet spinning application of fibrous material represents another example of a method of applying a fabric or fibrous material (e.g., polymeric fibrous material) to surfaces of a stent or other medical device implant component in a way that can reduce labor time and production costs. By way of illustration, rotary-jet-spun material may be applied to a medical device implant (e.g., metal stent) while the implant and a supporting holder are rotated by a rotary tool. Over time, the rotary jet spinning process can produce a layer of polymeric threads or fibers covering the outside of the target surface. Rotary jet spinning generally does not require use of any electric field, unlike electrospinning. Rotary jet spinning, as described in greater detail below, can involve conversion of a material (e.g., polymer) dissolved in a solvent into a continuous fibrous strand/fiber by centrifugal ejection of the material/solvent at a high speed, such that the ejected strand/fiber at least partially coats or is otherwise applied to a target surface. For example, the target surface may comprise a surface of a medical device component (e.g., stent/frame), which may be rotated as well to cover a varying surface area. Certain methods, devices, and systems relating to rotary jet spinning concepts that may be applicable to embodiments of the present disclosure are disclosed in U.S. Pat. No. 9,410,267, the disclosure of which is hereby incorporated by reference herein in its entirety for all purposes.

(69) Rotary jet spinning systems and process can involve imparting rotational motion to a reservoir holding a polymer solution, the rotational motion causing the polymer to be ejected from one or more orifices in the reservoir. Such processes can further involve collecting the formed fibers on a holder having a desired shape to form micron-, submicron- or nanometer-dimensioned polymeric fibers as a covering for component(s) of a medical implant device component. FIG. 8A shows a system **800** for applying a rotary jet spinning material **85** to a stent or other medical implant device component **73** coupled to a holder component **70** that is associated with a rotating mandrel **75**. The system **800** may comprise a rotary motor (e.g., pneumatic motor) **86**, which may be configured to drive the rotation of a reservoir **80**. The reservoir **80** is shown in close-up in FIG. 8B. In some embodiments, the polymer solution is extruded through a small orifice **89**. The extrusion of the solution can produce a plane **81** of fibers **85** into which the rotating holder **70** is translated into and out of during the collection process in a desired translation sequence.

(70) The rotation of the mandrel **75** and holder **70** can be driven by a motor **11**. Furthermore, the mandrel **75** and holder **70** may be mounted on a linear motor **12** configured to effect vertical translation of the mandrel **75** and holder **70**. The motor **12** may be considered a fiber plane translation motor and may comprise, for example, a uniaxial high precision linear drive that is configured to translate the collector assembly **79** along an axis **13** parallel to the rotation axis **83** of the rotating reservoir **80**, which corresponds to vertical translation with respect to the illustrated orientation of FIG. 8A. The axis **83** may be referred to as the deposition rotation axis. In some embodiments, one or more additional linear drives can be employed to translate the rotating mandrel **75** and holder **70** along one or more axes perpendicular to the rotation axis **83** of the rotating reservoir(s) (e.g., movement toward and away from the deposition rotation axis **83**). In some embodiments, a multi-axial drive or a robotic arm could be employed for to provide increased flexibility in translation and/or changing an angular alignment of the holder **70**.

(71) The mandrel **75** and holder **70** can represent components of the collection assembly **79**, at least part of which can be inserted into the path/plane **81** of the polymeric fibers **85**. The axis **14** about which the mandrel/holder **70** is rotated may be referred to as the collection rotation axis, or mandrel/holder rotation axis. When the holder **70** is in the path/plane **81** of the polymeric fibers **85**

ejected from the rotating reservoir **80**, the polymeric fibers **85** can become wrapped around the holder **70** via rotation of the holder **70** about the collection rotation axis **14** as the holder **70** is translated along the axis **13**.

(72) In some embodiments, methods of depositing fibrous material on a medical implant device component involve feeding a polymer into the rotating reservoir **80** and generating rotational motion at a speed, and for a time, sufficient to form a micron-, submicron-, or nanometer-dimensioned polymeric fiber, and collecting the formed fibers on a medical implant device (not shown in detail; see FIGS. **10-40** for example embodiments of medical implant devices that may be mounted on, or otherwise secured by or held to, the holder **70**) to form the micron-, submicron-, or nanometer-dimensioned polymeric fiber covering in the desired shape/configuration. In some embodiments, fibrous strands are produced by subjecting the polymer solution to a sufficient amount of pressure/stress for a time sufficient to form a fibrous covering on one or more components of a medical implant device in the desired shape and/or configuration. For example, a sufficient pressure/stress to produce fibrous strands from the polymer solution may be about 3,000 Pascals, or more.

(73) In some embodiments, the system **800** is at least partially automated by control circuitry **5** configured to control one or more of the rotation rate of the reservoir **80**, the rotation rate of the holder **70**, and the linear and/or multi-dimensional translation of the holder **70** along the axis **13** parallel to the rotation axis **83** of the rotating reservoir and/or one or more other axes, through the generation and/or transmission of electrical signals to one or more components of the system **800**.

(74) Control over the rate of translation of the holder **70** along the axis **13** and/or the orientation of the collection axis **14** relative to the reservoir rotation axis **83** can provide at least partial control over the orientation of fibers deposited on the collection holder **70**. For example, fibers may be collected on the holder **70** substantially parallel to the reservoir rotation axis **83**, and with slow translation along the collection rotation axis **14**. In some implementations, the rotation of the collection device (e.g., holder **70**) may be opposite the rotation of the reservoir **80** (e.g., counter-clockwise and clockwise, respectively) or the rotation of the collection device **70** may be the same as the rotation of the reservoir **80** (e.g., both counter-clockwise). In some implementations, by slowly moving the collection device (e.g., holder **70**) along the axis **13** through a path of the polymeric fibers **85** while rotating the collection device/assembly **70**, completely aligned coverage of the holder and/or medical device component held thereby.

(75) As shown in FIG. **8A**, the collection rotation axis **14** may be oriented at an angle θ with respect to the deposition rotation axis **83**. Such a configuration may result in fiber collection on the collection assembly **70** with crossed polymeric fibers. By increasing the speed of translation and/or rotating the holder **70** at a nonzero angle θ with respect to the deposition rotation axis **83**, crossed weaves can be produced. The collection assembly **79** may be moved manually or mechanically.

(76) In some embodiments, the system **800** includes a platform **10** for supporting the deposit of fibrous material, wherein the deposition assembly (**80, 86**) and the collection assembly (**70, 71, 73, 76 11**) are disposed vertically above the platform **10** and/or spaced from the platform **10** along the vertical axis **13**. Sufficient rotational speeds and times for operating the rotating structure **80** to form a fiber may be dependent on the concentration of the material/solution and the desired features of the formed fiber. Exemplary speeds of rotation of the rotating structure may range from about 100 rpm to about 500,000 rpm, although rotational speeds are not limited to this exemplary range. Furthermore, the rotating structure **80** may be rotated to impact the liquid material for a time sufficient to form a desired fiber, such as, for example, an amount of time between about 1-100 minutes, or other intermediate times or ranges are also intended to be part of this invention. The force or energy imparted by the rotating structure **80** advantageously overcomes the surface tension of the solution and decouples a portion of the liquid material at a meniscus thereof and flings the portion away from the contact with the rotating structure and from a platform (not shown) on which the liquid is maintained, thereby forming fiber(s). The fiber(s) may be collected on the collection

device **70**. In some embodiments, the direction in which the liquid material is flung may be substantially the same as the tangential direction of motion of the rotating structure of the reservoir **80** that contacts the liquid material. In some embodiments, the rotating structure may impart a force to the liquid material in a substantially parallel direction to the top surface of the liquid material.

(77) Any suitable size or geometrically-shaped reservoir **80** or collector **70** may be used for fabricating/collecting polymeric fibers. For example, the reservoir **80** may be tubular, conical, semilunar, bicuspid, round, rectangular, or oval. The holder **70** may be round, oval, rectangular, or a half-heart shape. The holder **70** may also be shaped in the form of any living organ, such as a heart, kidney, liver lobe(s), bladder, uterus, intestine, skeletal muscle, or lung shape, or portion thereof. The holder **70** may further be shaped as any hollow cavity, organ or tissue, such as a circular muscle structure, e.g., a valve, sphincter or iris.

(78) The collection device **70** may be a holder configured in a desired shape and positioned in the path of the polymer ejected from the one or more orifices or in the path of the fibers flung from the rotating structure **80**. In some embodiments, the collection device **70** may be disposed at a distance of about 2 inches (about 5 cm) to about 12 inches (about 30 cm) from the reservoir **80** from which the polymer is ejected. Certain exemplary distances may include, but are not limited to 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12 inches (5, 7.6, 10.2, 12.7, 15.2, 17.8, 20.3, 22.9, 25.4, 27.9, 30 cm), and all intermediate numbers. This distance may be selected and/or configured to avoid formation of fibrous beads (which may occur if the collection device **70** is too close to the reservoir **80**) and to achieve sufficient fibrous mass (which may not occur if the collection device is too far from the reservoir). In some implementations, formation of fibrous beads is implemented intentionally to provide desired fiber characteristics.

(79) FIGS. **9** and **10** show side views of examples of collection assemblies comprising spacer-type (e.g., cylinder-form) and arm-type holders, respectively, coupled to a rotating mandrel (**973**, **1073**) which may be coupled to one or more motion-generators for imparting rotational and/or linear motion to the mandrel and holder. Collection devices in accordance with embodiments of the present disclosure may be rotated about at speeds ranging from, for example, about 1,000 rpm to about 80,000 rpm, but are not limited to this exemplary range. For example, rotational speeds of collection devices may range from about 1,000 rpm-50,000 rpm, about 1,000 rpm to about 40,000 rpm, about 1,000 rpm to about 20,000 rpm, about 5,000 rpm to about 20,000 rpm, about 5,000 rpm to about 15,000 rpm, or about 50,000 rpm to about 400,000 rpm, and/or ranges and values intermediate to the above recited ranges and values.

(80) An exemplary collection device, e.g., holder, may be linearly translated relative to the rotational axis **83** of the rotating reservoir **80** of the fiber formation system **800** (e.g., translated up and down along an axis **13** parallel to the rotation axis **83** of the rotating structure/reservoir **80** of the fiber formation system **800** or translated back and forth along an axis at an angle to the rotational axis of the rotating structure/reservoir) at linear speeds ranging from about 1 mm/s to about 300 mm/s. Ranges and speeds intermediate to the recited ranges and speeds are also contemplated by the present invention. In some embodiments, the rotating reservoir **80** of the fiber formation system **800** may also, or alternatively, be translated relative to the collection assembly **79** during collection of the fibers. The translation of the collection assembly **79** relative to the rotating reservoir **80** may bring the collection assembly **79** in and out of the plane **81** through which the flung or ejected fibers **85** travel (e.g., the fiber plane **81**) to promote complete fiber coverage.

(81) With further reference to FIGS. **9** and **10**, example stents **910**, **1010** are shown on the spacer-type (e.g., cylinder-form) **977** and arm-type **1077** holders, respectively, which may allow for application/deposition of fibrous material on the stents **910**, **1010** using rotary jet spinning, as described in detail herein. In some embodiments, a stent can be formed of a biocompatible metal frame, such as stainless steel, cobalt-chrome alloy, or nitinol.

(82) With respect to FIG. **9**, the medical implant device **910** (e.g., stent) can be placed on the holder **977**, which may have any suitable or desirable form or shape. In some embodiments, the device

910 is placed about a cylindrical holder having a length $L_{sub.1}$ equal to or greater than an axial length $L_{sub.2}$ of the implant device **910**. In some embodiments, the length $L_{sub.1}$ of the cylindrical holder is equal to or greater than twice the length $L_{sub.2}$ of the implant device **910**. Such a length of the cylindrical portion **977** may permit an invertible portion of fibrous covering (not shown) to extend beyond the implant device **910** in one or more directions by an amount sufficient to allow the excess portion of fibrous covering to be folded back onto an inner or outer surface of the implant device. That is, while the fibers are being applied to the implant device **910**, the fibers may also layer over at least a portion of the holder **977** that supports the implant device **910**. In some embodiments, the holder **977** and/or mandrel **973** may be shaped and configured such that at least a portion of the fibrous covering that extends axially beyond the implant device **910** forms a layer of fibrous material in the shape/form of a cylinder or cone. This cylinder/cone of polymeric material can then be used as an inner layer of material for the implant device **910** (e.g., stent) by folding or placing the material inside the stent. In some implementations, the folding/placement of the excess layer of fibrous material inside the implant device may be accomplished by moving the stent **910** with respect to the holder **977**, which may at least partially invert the cylinder/cone of fibrous material and wrap it in toward the inner surface of the implant device. In this way, both the inner and outer surfaces of the implant device may be fully encased with fibrous material without the need for applying and sewing a pre-made polymeric cloth.

(83) The holder **977** may be threaded onto the mandrel **973**. For example, the holder **977** can have an internal bore (not shown) through which the mandrel **973** may be threaded. The holder **977** can comprise any suitable material, including but not limited to metal, such as stainless steel, ceramic, or polymer. In some embodiments, the holder **977** includes a 3D-printed polymer fixture or a balloon. The holder **977** advantageously has a diameter less than that of the implant device **910**. For example, the holder **977** may have a cylinder form having a diameter that is greater than the diameter of the mandrel **973** and slightly less than the internal diameter of the implant device **910**. In some embodiments, the holder **977** comprises a lubricious coating, which can facilitate axial movement of the implant device **910** on the holder **977**.

(84) In some implementations, the cylinder form of the holder **977** may be coated with a fibrous layer, which may be applied through rotary jet spinning, that extends beyond the implant device **910** on the cylinder by an amount sufficient to allow the excess portion of the fibrous layer to be folded back onto the outer surface of the implant device **910**, producing a second layer of fibrous material covering the outer surface of the implant device **910** when implemented as described below. For example, the fibrous layer may be applied to the cylinder **977**, after which the implant device **910** may be placed on the cylinder. Subsequent folding of the fibrous layer over the outer portion of the implant device **910** can result in at least a portion of both the inner portion and the outer portion of the implant device **910** being covered by fibrous material. In some embodiments, the holder **977** is integrated with the mandrel **973**. For example, the holder **977** and the mandrel **973** can be embodied in a unitary form.

(85) In FIG. **10**, the holder **1077** is attached to the rotating mandrel **1073** in such a way as to translate rotation of the mandrel **1073** to rotation of the holder **1077**. With respect to FIGS. **9** and **10**, the mandrels **973**, **1073** may comprise a stainless-steel rod. The rod may be approximately 3 mm in diameter, although mandrels of different diameters and materials may alternatively be used. The mandrels **973**, **1073** advantageously have a diameter that is less than the diameter of the stents **910**, **1010**.

(86) The holder **1077** can include any number of arms **1079** or other attachment members, which can be secured in any suitable or desirable way to the implant device **1010** (e.g., stent). In the illustrated embodiments of FIGS. **9** and **10**, the medical implant devices **910**, **1010** can comprise a stent having a first end **986**, **1086** that follows a generally circular, undulating path having alternating arcuate troughs and pointed peaks that generally correspond to the undulating contour of the underside of a sewing ring (not shown) for use as part of a prosthetic heart valve. A second

end **994**, **1094** of the stent can substantially form a circle without undulations. A mid-section of the stent may be made up of one or more rows of expandable struts **998**, **1098** extending circumferentially in a sawtooth or chevron pattern between axially-extending struts.

(87) The holder **1077** is used to hold the implant device (e.g., stent) **1010**. In some embodiments, the holder includes a central hub portion **1066**, which may have a generally tubular form, and a plurality of stabilizing arms **1079** projecting axially and radially outward therefrom. In the embodiment shown, the holder **1077** has three stabilizing arms **1079**, although a holder having greater or fewer stabilizing arms may be used. The central hub portion **1066** can have an internal bore **1070**. The holder **1077** may be formed of a rigid polymer, such as acetal (DELTRIN® polymer, DuPont), nylon, polypropylene, or the like. In some embodiments, the holder **1077** is integrated with the mandrel **1073**. For example, the holder **1077** and the mandrel **1073** can be embodied in a unitary form. In some implementations, the medical implant device **910** is directly secured to the stabilizing arms **1079** of the holder **1077** using sutures or other attachment means or mechanism at commissure ends or other attachment features **1072** of the medical implant device **1010**. Example attachment means or mechanisms for attaching/coupling the implant device **1010** to the holder **1077** include, but are not limited to, one or more pins, clips, clamps, tabs, adhesive elements, hooks, or other structurally- or frictionally-based attachment features.

(88) The holder **1077** may be threaded onto the mandrel **1073** via, for example, the internal bore **1070** of the holder **1077**. In some embodiments, the holder **1077** (and medical implant device **1010**) may be left free to translate along an axis of the mandrel **1073**. In some embodiments, the holder **1077** may be secured to the mandrel **1073**, for example, mechanically or adhesively using an adhesive element, or other attachment means as described herein. Examples of suitable adhesive elements in accordance with aspects of the present disclosure can comprise epoxy, adhesive tape, and/or the like. Although a single holder device **1077** is shown in FIG. **10**, other embodiments may include additional/secondary holders and/or other support frames.

(89) Various medical device components may advantageously be at least partially covered in fibrous material, as described herein. For example, with respect to prosthetic heart valve implant devices, a fibrous sealing and/or skirt portion can be sutured to a frame of a prosthetic heart valve to help prevent blood from leaking around the outer edges or circumference of the prosthetic heart valve. FIG. **11** illustrates an example stent **210** that may be used in a prosthetic heart valve implant device in accordance with one or more embodiments of the present disclosure. The stent **210** may be made from laser-cut tubing of a plastically-expandable metal or other at least partially rigid material. In some implementations, the stent frame **210** may further be treated to be at least partially self-expanding. Although a laser-cut stent is shown, it should be understood that the fiber-application processes and devices disclosed herein apply to other types of stents as well, including stents comprising rigid rings, spirally-wound tubes, and other tubes/conduits that fit within, for example, a heart valve annulus and that define an orifice therethrough for the passage of blood.

(90) The stent **210** may be at least partially self-expanding and/or may be mechanically expandable (e.g., balloon-expandable). For example, a self-expanding stent may be crimped or otherwise compressed into a small tube and may possess sufficient elasticity to spring outward by itself when a restraint, such as an outer sheath/catheter, is removed. In contrast, a balloon-expanding stent may comprise material that is relatively less elastic and is capable of plastic expansion from the inside-out when converting the stent from a contracted diameter/configuration to an expanded diameter/configuration. The plastic expansion may be accomplished with a balloon or other device, such as a device with mechanical fingers. With such balloon-expanding stents, the stent frame may plastically deform after the application of a deformation force, such as an inflating balloon or expanding mechanical fingers.

(91) The stent **210** (e.g., self-expanding stent or balloon-expanding stent) may be used as part of a prosthetic heart valve having a single-stage implantation in which a surgeon secures a heart valve having a fibrous anchoring skirt and valve member to a heart valve annulus as one unit or piece.

Certain stent solutions for aortic valve replacement in accordance with some embodiments of the present disclosure are disclosed in U.S. Pat. No. 8,641,757, which is incorporated herein by reference in its entirety for all purposes. In some implementations, an exemplary delivery system advances the valve implant device with the stent at the leading or distal end until it is located within the valve annulus and/or left ventricular outflow tract, at which point a balloon can inflate to expand the stent against the aortic annulus and/or ventricular tissue.

(92) In the illustrated embodiment of Figure ii, the stent frame **210** is generally annular and/or cylindrical in shape and includes a plurality of angularly-spaced, vertically-extending, commissure attachment posts, or struts, **218**. Posts **218** can be interconnected at least by a lower row of circumferentially-extending struts **220** and one or more upper rows of circumferentially extending struts **222** and **224**, respectively. The struts in each row can be arranged in a zig-zag or generally saw-tooth-like pattern extending in the direction of the circumference of the frame, as shown. Adjacent struts in the same row can be interconnected to one another to form an angle between about 90-110 degrees. The angle between adjacent struts can be selected to optimize the radial strength of the frame **210** when expanded yet still permit the frame **210** to be evenly crimped and expanded.

(93) In the illustrated embodiment, pairs of adjacent circumferential struts in the same row are connected to each other by a respective, generally U-shaped crown structure or portion **226**. The crown structures **26** can each include a horizontal portion extending between and connecting the adjacent ends of the struts such that a gap is defined between the adjacent ends and the crown structure connects the adjacent ends at a location offset from the strut's natural point of intersection. The crown structures **226** can significantly reduce residual strains on the frame **210** at the location of the struts **220**, **222**, **224** during crimping and expanding of the frame **210**. Each pair of struts **222** connected at a common crown structure **226** may generally form a cell with an adjacent pair of struts **224** in the row above. Each cell can be connected to an adjacent cell at a node **232**. Each node **232** can be interconnected with the lower row of struts by a respective vertical (axial) strut **230** that is connected to, and extends between, a respective node **232** and a location on the lower row of struts **220** where two struts are connected at their ends opposite of a crown structures **226**.

(94) In certain embodiments, lower struts **220** have a greater thickness or diameter than upper struts **222**, **224**. In one implementation, for example, lower struts **220** have a thickness of about 0.42 mm and upper struts **222**, **224** have a thickness of about 0.38 mm. In the particular embodiment of FIG. **11**, because there is only one row of lower struts **220** and two rows of upper struts **222**, **224**, enlargement of the lower struts **220** with respect to the upper struts **222**, **224** can advantageously enhance the radial strength of the frame **210** at the lower area of the frame and/or allow for more uniform expansion of the frame. Columns of the frame **210** can be defined by the adjoining pairs of struts **220**, **222**, **224** extending between two axially-extending struts **230**. In some embodiments, the frame **210** comprises three 120-degree segments, with each segment being bounded by two posts **218**. Accordingly, the frame **210** of the particular embodiment of FIG. **11** includes 9 total columns. In some embodiments, the number of columns and rows may be desirably minimized to reduce the overall crimp profile of the frame **210** and/or associated valve.

(95) FIG. **12** shows the heart valve stent **210** disposed about a spacer-form holder **277**, such as a cylinder-type holder as described herein. Although a spacer-form holder is shown in FIG. **12**, it should be understood that any type of holder may be used to hold the stent **210**, including holders having arms or other attachment features, as described herein. The mandrel **273** and holder **277** can be part of a collector assembly **270**, as described in detail herein.

(96) With the stent **210** disposed on the holder **277**, the mandrel **273** and coupled holder **277** can be rotated about the axis **274** defined by the mandrel **273**. For example, the collector assembly **270** can comprise a rotor motor configured to rotate the mandrel **273**. The various components of the collector assembly **270** may be controlled at least in part by control circuitry of a local and/or remote controller system.

(97) Fibrous material may be applied to the stent **210** and/or holder **277** using a rotary jet spinning deposition system, which may be similar in certain respects to the system **800** shown in FIGS. **8A** and **8B**. For example, a rotating reservoir containing a solution may be rotated at sufficient speed to eject/expel a plane of fibrous strand(s), as shown in FIGS. **8A** and **8B**. The fibrous strand(s) can be applied to at least a portion of the outer surface of the stent **210** and to at least a portion of the holder **277** to form a layer of fibrous material **202**, as shown in FIG. **13**.

(98) The application of the rotary-jet-spun fibrous material may produce a first portion **201** of the layer of fibrous material **202** on the outer surface of the stent **210** and a second portion **203** of the layer of fibrous material on the outer surface of the holder **277**. In some implementations, a cone form (not shown) of the fibrous material **202** forms and extends between the proximal end **209** of the holder **277** and the mandrel **273**.

(99) After application of the fibrous material **202** to the stent **210**, the stent **210** and/or additional fibrous material deposited on the holder may be withdrawn from the collection assembly **270**. The removal of the surplus portion **203** of the layer of fibrous material **202** may be accomplished, for example, by cutting the layer of fibrous material at or near the mandrel **273**. At least a portion of the second portion **203** of the fibrous material may be folded under the stent **210** to provide a two-sided covering of the stent **210**. In some implementations, application of the surplus fibrous material can be accomplished simply by moving the stent **210** relative to the holder **277** and allowing the surplus portion to become inverted between the stent **210** and the holder **277**. In some implementations, application of the surplus fibrous material to the inside of the stent **210** is performed manually and/or using one or more tools. Processes of depositing fibrous material on a medical device can be performed as many times as desired and/or for the desired amount of time in order to produce the desired thickness of fibrous material.

(100) FIG. **14** illustrates the frame **210** of FIGS. **11-13** incorporated in an implantable prosthetic valve **260** in accordance with one or more embodiments. As assembled, the valve **260** in the illustrated embodiment includes a leaflet structure **264** supported by the stent frame **210**, which includes a fabric skirt **201** applied to the stent frame **210** using rotary jet spinning technology as described above. The valve implant device **260** can be suitable for implantation in the annulus of a native aortic valve, for example, but also can be adapted to be implanted in other native valve annuli of the heart or in various other ducts or orifices of the body. The valve implant device **260** has a “lower” end **280** and an “upper” end **282**. In the context of the present application, the terms “lower” and “upper” are used interchangeably with the terms “inflow” and “outflow,” respectively, in some contexts. Thus, for example, the lower end **280** of the valve may be considered the inflow end and the upper end **282** of the valve may be considered the outflow end.

(101) The valve implant device **260** and stent frame **210** are configured to be radially collapsible to a collapsed or crimped state for introduction into the body within a delivery catheter and radially expandable to an expanded state for implanting the valve **260** at a desired location in the body (e.g., the native aortic valve). For example, the stent frame **210** can be made of a plastically-expandable material that permits crimping of the valve to a smaller profile for delivery and expansion of the valve using an expansion device, such as the balloon of a balloon catheter. Alternatively, the valve implant device **260** can be a self-expanding valve, wherein the frame is made of a self-expanding material such as a shape memory metal (e.g., nitinol). A self-expanding valve can be crimped to a smaller profile and held in the crimped state with a restraining device, such as a sheath covering the valve. When the valve is positioned at or near the target site, the restraining device may be removed to allow the valve to self-expand to its expanded, functional size.

(102) Although FIGS. **11-14** show components for a transcatheter heart valve and associated stent having a particular form and features, it should be understood that the rotary jet spinning processes and systems described herein are suitable for application of fibrous material to stents and/or valve devices having any suitable or desirable form and/or features. FIG. **15** shows an example heart valve implant device **291** including a stent **295** that has fibrous material applied to a portion thereof

using a rotary jet spinning process in accordance with embodiments of the present disclosure. Unlike the stent **210** of FIGS. **11-14**, the stent **295** does not have uniform cross-sectional shape or diameter along a length thereof. For example, the stent **295** includes a lower end having a diameter **D1** that is less than the diameter **D2** at an upper end, as shown. In some embodiments, the stent **295** may have one or more tapered longitudinal portions **294**, **293**, and/or **292**, as illustrated. The tapered portion(s) can bridge between smaller and larger diameters of the stent **295**.

(103) Due to the tapered (e.g., hour-glass) shape of the stent **295**, the holder used to apply the fibrous material **297** to the stent **295** may advantageously be configured to accommodate such shape at least in part. For example, a holder device may be used that has non-cylindrical shape over at least a portion of the longitudinal area thereof. In some embodiments, a holder having one or more arm support members may be used, or alternatively, a spacer-type holder device may be used that has an at least partially tapered shape or portion to match or accommodate at least the portion **294** of the stent **295** that is to be covered with fibrous material. In some embodiments, an at least partially conical holder may be used for a device similar to the device **291** of FIG. **15**. In some implementations, fibrous material may be applied to the stent **295** over one or more longitudinal portions thereof, whereas one or more portions (e.g., **292**, **293**) may be left uncovered.

(104) FIG. **16** shows another example of a heart valve implant device having non-uniform stent diameter with respect to the stent component **245**. As shown, at least a portion **243** of the stent **245** may advantageously be covered with fibrous material using rotary jet spinning, as described in detail herein. In some embodiments, the stent **245** can have one or more bulge features **242**, which may advantageously be configured to accommodate certain cardiac anatomy associated with a target implantation site. The valve device **241** further includes a plurality of leaflets **244**. In some embodiments, the valve device **241** is a replacement aortic valve implant device.

(105) The stent **245** may be attached to any type of holder for application of the fibrous material **247** using a rotary jet spinning system and/or process. For example, a holder having one or more arm support members may be used, or alternatively, a spacer-type holder device may be used that has an at least partially angled or tapered shape or portion to match or accommodate at least the portion **243** of the stent **245** that is to be covered with fibrous material.

(106) In addition to transcatheter heart valve and stent components, other types of prosthetic heart valve implant devices can include component(s) that are desirably at least partially covered in fibrous material using rotary jet spinning processes, as described herein. For example, FIG. **17** is a perspective view of a prosthetic heart valve implant device **410** in accordance with one or more embodiments. The heart valve **410** can include a peripheral sealing ring structure **491** configured to provide support for nesting the heart valve **410** in a heart valve cavity and/or resting upon, or attaching to, an annulus or other cardiac structure/anatomy. The valve **410** further includes a frame member **492**, such as a metal frame, which can provide support for a plurality of flexible leaflets **493** and defines three upstanding commissure posts **494**, wherein the leaflets **493** are supported between the commissure posts **494**. The heart valve **410** is illustrated in a closed position in which fluid flow through the valve is inhibited; when in an at least partially-open state, fluid (e.g., blood) can flow in one direction through an inner channel of the valve that is formed when the leaflets **493** separate.

(107) The valve leaflets **493** can comprise three separate flaps of tissue, such as xenograft tissue (e.g., bovine pericardium), or all three leaflets can be derived from a single xenograft valve (e.g., a porcine valve). The leaflets **493** can be secured and supported both by the commissure posts **494**, as well as along arcuate cusps **495** of the frame member between the commissure posts. In some embodiments, the leaflets **493** are matched for thickness and/or elasticity in order to desirably occlude fluid flow through the valve **410**. The leaflets **493** extend inward from the surrounding frame **492** into a flow orifice defined thereby. In certain embodiments, the leaflets **493** curve toward the outflow direction and “coapt” in the middle of the valve orifice to facilitate one-way flow through the valve **410**.

(108) The frame member **492** can comprise an at least partially flexible wireform made of metal alloy or other metal or at least partially rigid material. In some embodiments, the frame member **492** is configured to reduce loading shock on the leaflets **493** during the cardiac cycle. The sealing ring **491** can attach around the periphery of the frame member **492** at the inflow end of the valve, with the commissure posts **494** projecting in the outflow direction. The frame member **492** can be generally rigid and/or expansion-resistant in order to substantially maintain a particular shape and diameter of the valve orifice and also to maintain the valve leaflets **493** in proper alignment in order for the valve to properly close and open. Although a substantially round embodiment is depicted in FIG. 17, other shapes are also within the scope of the invention, depending on the particular application (e.g., the particular native valve to be replaced, etc.).

(109) The valve device **410** can further include a support structure **497** designed to fit above the sealing ring **491**. In certain embodiments, the support structure **497** is made of metal and/or plastic (e.g., polyester, polyethylene terephthalate (PET), or biaxially-oriented PET, for example, MYLAR PET, DuPont Teijin Films) component(s), wherein the leaflets **493** can be sewn or otherwise attached to, for example, a plastic band component of the support structure **497**. The support structure **497** can comprise a rigid stiffening band, which can be comprised of, for example, metal or other rigid material. The support structure **497** can include commissure support portions that extend vertically with respect to the illustrated orientation of FIG. 17, which can fit at least partially within the upwardly-projecting commissure regions **494** of the frame member **492**.

(110) The sealing ring **491** of the heart valve implant device **410** can be configured to at least partially stabilize the annulus and to support the functional changes that occur during the cardiac cycle, such as by maintaining coaptation and valve integrity to prevent reverse flow while permitting good hemodynamics during forward flow. The sealing ring **491** can comprise an inner at least partially rigid substrate (e.g., metal such as stainless steel or titanium, or a flexible material such as silicone rubber or PET cordage). The sealing ring **491** can be stiff or flexible, can be split or continuous, and can have a variety of shapes, including circular, D-shaped, kidney-shaped, or C-shaped. In certain embodiments, when implanted, suture fasteners (not shown) can be distributed around the sealing ring **491** that bind the sealing ring to the attachment tissue of the patient.

(111) In some embodiments, the valve **410** further comprises a sub-annular frame **404**. The frame **404** can provide improved support and/or sealing functionality when implanted in, for example, an aortic valve annulus. The frame **410** may be made from laser-cut tubing of a plastically expandable metal or other at least partially rigid material. In some implementations, the frame **410** may further be treated to be at least partially self-expanding. Although a laser-cut sub-annular frame is shown, it should be understood that the fiber-application processes and devices disclosed herein apply to other types of frames as well, including frames comprising rigid rings, spirally-wound tubes, and other tubes that fit within, for example, a heart valve annulus and that define an orifice therethrough for the passage of blood.

(112) FIG. 18 shows the heart valve assembly **410** disposed on a holder **479**, such as an arm-type holder as described herein. Although an arm holder is shown in FIG. 18, it should be understood that any type of holder may be used to hold the valve **410**, including cylindrical or other-shaped spacer-type holders or other attachment features, as described herein. The mandrel **473** and holder **479** may be part of a collector assembly **470**, as described in detail herein.

(113) With the valve assembly **410** disposed on the holder **479**, the mandrel **473** and coupled holder **479** can be rotated about the axis defined by the mandrel **473**. For example, the collector assembly **470** can comprise a rotor motor configured to rotate the mandrel **473**. The various components of the collector assembly **470** may be controlled at least in part by control circuitry of a local and/or remote controller system.

(114) Fibrous material may be applied to the valve assembly **410** using a rotary jet spinning deposition system, which may be similar in certain respects to the system **800** shown in FIGS. 8A and 8B. For example, a rotating reservoir containing a solution may be rotated at sufficient speed to

eject/expel a plane of fibrous strand(s), as shown in FIGS. 8A and 8B. The fibrous strand(s) can be applied to at least a portion of the outer surface of the frame **492**, sealing ring **491**, and skirt frame **404** to form one or more layers of fibrous material, as shown in FIG. 19. Although FIG. 18 shows the leaflets **493** attached to the valve assembly **410**, in some implementations, the fibrous material may be applied to the valve frame assembly **410** prior to application of the valve leaflets **493**. In certain preferred embodiments, valve leaflets are applied/attached after the relevant rotary jet spinning process(es) for application of fibrous material. In some implementations, some and/or each component requiring fibrous material coating/application (e.g. **404**, **494**, **491**) can be processed using rotary jet spinning for application of fibrous material thereto individually.

(115) FIG. 19 shows a surgical heart valve having fibrous material applied to portions thereof using rotary jet spinning in accordance with one or more embodiments of the present disclosure. The fiber-covered peripheral sealing ring structure **491** can be configured to provide support for nesting the heart valve **410** in a heart valve cavity and/or resting upon, or attaching to, an annulus or other structure of the heart. The fiber-covered frame member **492** provides support for the plurality of flexible leaflets **493** and defines the upstanding commissure posts **494**, wherein the leaflets **493** can be supported between the commissure posts **494**. The sealing ring **491** can be attached around the periphery of the frame member **494** towards the inflow end of the valve **410**, with the commissure posts **494** projecting in the outflow direction. The leaflets **493** can be formed from separate flaps of material or tissue, such as, for example, xenograft tissue (e.g., bovine pericardium), or the leaflets **493** can be derived from a single xenograft valve (e.g., a porcine valve). The leaflets **493** can be secured and supported both by the commissure posts **494**, as well as along arcuate cusps of the frame member between the commissure posts.

(116) Rotary jet spinning can be used to apply fibrous material **401** having a first set of characteristics to a first portion **411** of the valve assembly **410**, such as to the commissure posts **494** and/or sealing ring **491**, whereas fibrous material **402** having a second set of characteristics is applied to a second portion **412** of the valve assembly **410**. For example, the fibrous material **401** may be relatively smooth, whereas the fibrous material **402** may be relatively textured to provide a secure fit in the valve annulus to aid sealing. The fibrous material **401** and/or fibrous material **402** may comprise polymetric fibrous material, as described in detail herein. Processes of depositing the fibrous material **401** and/or **402** can be performed as many times as desired and/or for the desired amount of time in order to produce the desired thickness of fibrous material.

(117) The frame **494** can be covered with the fibrous material **401** using rotary jet spinning process(es). In some implementations, the fibrous material **401**, after rotary jet spinning application thereof, can be sutured in one or more portions to secure the fibrous material **401** as a covering for the frame **492**, as shown. In some implementations, one or more seams may be sutured adjacent an inflow edge that secures the fibrous material **401** about the support stent and/or in other location(s). The frame **492** and/or one or more other components of the valve implant device **410** can also have the leaflets **493** and/or other materials sutured thereto.

(118) The anchoring skirt portion **412** is shown as being associated with the inflow end of the valve device **410**. The frame **404** of the anchoring skirt **412** can be expandable, such as self-expanding, to advantageously provide for secure attachment to the valve annulus and/or other anatomy associated with the target heart valve. For example, in some embodiments, the valve frame **492** and/or sealing ring **491** are non-expandable, whereas the anchoring skirt frame **404** can expand from the contracted state shown in FIGS. 17-19 to an expanded state. The size of the anchoring skirt **412** can vary depending upon the overall size of the heart valve **410**. The frame **404** of the valve **410** can comprise a generally tubular plastically-expandable structure having an undulating or scalloped lower end **409**, as shown. The coarse fibrous material **402** can allow for the skirt **412** to be sutured to the adjacent heart tissue.

(119) In addition to prosthetic heart valve and stent devices, other types of medical implant devices can include component(s) that are desirably at least partially covered in fibrous material using

rotary jet spinning processes, as described herein. For example, FIG. 20 is a side view of a prosthetic spacer device 500 configured to reduce or prevent valvular regurgitation when attached to one or more leaflets of, for example, a native mitral valve in accordance with one or more embodiments. Alternatively, the spacer device 500 can be implanted at the aortic, tricuspid, or pulmonary valve regions of a human heart according to a suitable implantation process. The prosthetic spacer device 500 can be used to help restore and/or improve the functionality of a defective native valve. For example, in some embodiments, the prosthetic spacer device 500 can include a central or main body 510 and one or more movable elements 540 configured to capture the leaflets of the native valve between the elements 540 and the main body 510. The native leaflets can thereby form a seal against the main body 510. The main body 510, in turn, can be configured to prevent blood flow through the prosthetic device such that an acute reduction in regurgitation (e.g., functional mitral regurgitation) is achieved after implantation. This can be advantageous in patients where left ventricular function is not severely degraded. Examples of other prosthetic spacer devices are described further in U.S. Patent Publication Number 2018/0325661, which is incorporated herein by reference for all purposes.

(120) In addition to the spacer member 510, the prosthetic spacer device 500 can comprise a plurality of anchors or paddles 540 (e.g., two in the illustrated embodiment), a plurality of clasps 506 (e.g., two in the illustrated embodiment), a first collar or hub member 508, and a second collar or hub member 509. First end portions 512 of the anchors 540 can be coupled to and extend from a first end portion 514 of the spacer member 510, and second end portions 516 of the anchors 540 can be coupled to the first collar 508. The second collar 509 can be coupled to a second end portion 518 of the spacer member 510.

(121) FIG. 21 shows the spacer device 500 coupled to a holder 579, such as an arm- or clip-type holder as described herein. Although a clip/arm holder is shown in FIG. 21, it should be understood that any type of holder may be used to hold the spacer device 500, including cylindrical or other-shaped spacer-type holders or other attachment features, as described herein. The mandrel 573 and holder 579 may be part of a collector assembly 570, as described in detail herein.

(122) The spacer device may be in an at least partially straightened-out configuration when fibrous material is applied thereto using rotary jet spinning. For example, in some implementations, an angle between the first portions 520 of the anchors 540 and the spacer member 510 can be approximately 180 degrees when the anchors 540 are in the straightened-out configuration, whereas the angle between the first portions 520 of the anchors 540 and the spacer member 510 can be approximately 0 degrees when the anchors 540 are in the fully folded configuration shown in FIG. 20. In some implementations, some and/or each component(s) (e.g., the spacer, the paddle) can be coated individually followed by assembly.

(123) With the spacer device 500 disposed on the holder 579, the mandrel 573 and coupled holder 579 can be rotated about the axis defined by the mandrel 573. For example, the collector assembly 570 can comprise or be mechanically coupled to a rotor motor configured to rotate the mandrel 573. The various components of the collector assembly 570 may be controlled at least in part by control circuitry of a local and/or remote controller system.

(124) Fibrous material may be applied to the spacer device 570 using a rotary jet spinning deposition system, which may be similar in certain respects to the system 800 shown in FIGS. 8A and 8B. For example, a rotating reservoir containing a solution may be rotated at sufficient speed to eject/expel a plane of fibrous strand(s), as shown in FIGS. 8A and 8B. The fibrous strand(s) can be applied to at least a portion of the spacer member 510, clasps 520, anchors 540, and/or distal collar 508 to form one or more layers of fibrous material, as shown in FIG. 21.

(125) FIG. 22 shows the spacer device 500 having fibrous material 550 applied to portions thereof using rotary jet spinning in accordance with one or more embodiments of the present disclosure. The spacer device 500 is shown in FIG. 22 with the fibrous material covering 550 disposed about the spacer member 510 and the anchors 540. In some examples, the fibrous material covering 550

can be porous such that the covering is at least partially permeable to blood flow. For example, the fibrous material covering **550** can be an openwork fabric or netting defining openings of any suitable or desirable dimensions. In certain examples, the fibrous material covering **550** can comprise a low-density rotary-jet-spun polymeric fibrous material having, for example, 60-120 courses per inch and/or 20-60 wales per inch. In order to produce the desired fibrous covering **550**, the rate of rotation of the rotary jet spinning reservoir and/or mandrel/holder, the rate of translation of the mandrel/holder, the angle and/or change in angle of the holder assembly may be controlled to produce the desired application of fibrous material.

(126) In some embodiments, the spacer device **500** can be configured to move between the configuration of FIG. **21** and the configuration of FIG. **22** by axially moving the first collar **508** and thus the anchors **540** relative to the spacer member **510** along a longitudinal axis extending between the first and second end portions **514**, **518** of the spacer member **510**. For example, the anchors **540** can be positioned in a straight configuration by moving the first collar **508** away from the spacer member **510** such that the anchors **540** become more taut/open.

(127) From the straightened-out configuration of FIG. **21**, the anchors **540** can be moved to the folded configuration of FIG. **22** by moving the first collar **508** toward the spacer member **510**. Initially, as the first collar **508** moves toward the spacer member **510**, the anchors **540** may bend at the joint portions **524**, and the joint portions **524** move radially outwardly relative to the longitudinal axis of the spacer member **510** and axially toward the first end portion **514** of the spacer member **510**, whereas as the collar **508** continues to move toward the spacer member **510**, the joint portions **524** may move radially inwardly relative to the longitudinal axis of the spacer member **510** and axially toward the second end portion **518** of the spacer member **510** until the folded configuration of FIG. **22** is achieved.

(128) FIGS. **23-25** and the accompanying description relate to embodiments of another example type of prosthetic heart valve device that can be covered at least in part by fibrous material using rotary jet spinning solutions as described herein. In some embodiments, the heart valve device frame **600** of FIGS. **23** and **24** is a component of a heart valve device **601** (see FIG. **25**) suitable for implantation as a replacement mitral valve. The frame **600** includes a frame body **602** having an upper region **610**, an intermediate region **620**, and a lower region **630**. The frame **600** can include a first type of anchoring feature **640** and a second type of anchoring feature **650**, either of which may serve as a proximal or distal anchoring feature.

(129) One or both anchoring features **640**, **650** can contact or engage a native valve annulus, such as the native mitral valve annulus, tissue beyond the native valve annulus, native leaflets, and/or other tissue at or around the implantation location. For example, when the frame **600** is used for a replacement mitral valve prosthesis, during at least the systolic phase of the cardiac cycle, the second anchoring feature **650** can be sized to contact or engage the native mitral valve annulus whereas the first anchoring feature **640** is sized to be spaced from the native mitral valve annulus.

(130) As shown, the frame body **602** can have a bulbous or slightly-bulbous shape, with the intermediate region **620** being larger than the upper region **610** and/or the lower region **630**. The bulbous shape of the frame body **602** can advantageously allow the frame body **602** to engage a native valve annulus or other body cavity, while spacing the inlet and outlet from the heart or vessel wall. This can advantageously reduce undesired contact between the prosthesis and the heart or vessel, such as the atrial and ventricular walls of the heart.

(131) The intermediate region **620** can be generally cylindrical in shape such that a diameter of an upper end of the intermediate region **620** and/or a diameter of a lower end of the intermediate region **620** is equal or generally equal to the diameter of a middle portion of the intermediate region **620**. The general uniformity of the diameter of the intermediate region **620** from the upper end to the lower end, in conjunction with the axial dimension between the upper end and the lower end (e.g., the “height” of the intermediate region **620**), provides for a significantly large circumferential area upon which a native valve annulus, or other body cavity, can be engaged. This can beneficially

improve securement of the frame **600** to the native valve annulus or other body cavity. This can also improve sealing between the frame **600** and the native valve annulus, or other body cavity, thereby reducing paravalvular leakage.

(132) In some embodiments, the frame body **602**, when in an expanded configuration, can have a diameter at its widest portion of between about 30 mm to about 60 mm, between about 65 mm to about 55 mm, about 40 mm, any sub-range within these ranges, or any other diameter as desired. In some embodiments, the frame body **602** in an expanded configuration has a diameter at its narrowest portion between about 20 mm to about 40 mm, any sub-range within these ranges, or any other diameter as desired. In the expanded configuration, the frame body **602** can have an axial dimension between the upper and lower ends of the frame body **602** (e.g., the “height” of the frame body **602**) of between about 10 mm to about 40 mm, between about 18 mm to about 60 mm, about 20 mm, any sub-range within these ranges, or any other height as desired.

(133) At the juncture between the intermediate region **620** and the upper region **610**, the frame body **602** can include a bend **612**. The bend **612** can be a radially inward bend towards the longitudinal axis of the frame **600** such that a portion of the upper region **610**, extending upwardly from the beginning of bend **612** adjacent the intermediate region **620**, is inclined or curved towards the longitudinal axis of the frame **600**. The inclined or curved portion of the upper region **610** can facilitate the securement of a supplemental prosthesis within the frame **600**.

(134) At the juncture between the intermediate region **620** and the lower region **630**, the frame body **602** can include a bend **632** toward the longitudinal axis of the frame **600**. The bend **632** can be a radially-inward bend towards the longitudinal axis of the frame **600** such that a portion of the lower region **630**, extending downwardly from the beginning of bend **632** adjacent the intermediate region **620**, is inclined or curved towards the longitudinal axis of the frame **600**. The bend **632** can generally form an arc with an angle between about 20 degrees to about 90 degrees. The lower region **630** can include a bend **634** below the bend **632**. The bend **634** can be oriented opposite that of the bend **632** such that a portion of the lower region **630**, extending downwardly from the beginning of the bend **634**, is inclined or curved at less of an angle towards the longitudinal axis of the frame **600** than the portion above the beginning of the bend **634**, is generally parallel to the longitudinal axis, or is inclined or curved at an angle away from the longitudinal axis of the frame **600**. The diameter of the upper end of the upper region **610** and the lower end of the lower region **630** may be about the same or may differ.

(135) The frame body **602** can include a plurality of struts with at least some of the struts forming cells **660a**, **660b**, **660c**. Any number of configurations of struts can be used, such as rings of undulating struts shown forming ellipses, ovals, rounded polygons, teardrops, chevrons, diamonds, curves, and/or various other shapes. In some embodiments, the frame body **602** can include three rows of cells **660a**, **660b**, **660c**.

(136) The cells **660a**, **660b**, **660c** can have any suitable or desirable shape, and can advantageously be self-expanding or otherwise expandable. For example, the cells of any of the rows may have a hexagonal or generally-hexagonal shape, diamond shape, or the like. The circumferentially-expandable struts **665** can be inclined or curved towards a longitudinal axis of the frame **600** such that an upper portion of the struts **665** are positioned closer to the longitudinal axis of the frame **600** than the lower portion of the struts **665**. The struts **670** can extend generally longitudinally and can incorporate the bend **612** such that an upper portion of the struts **670** are inclined or curved towards the longitudinal axis of the frame **600**.

(137) The lower portion of cells **660a** can be formed from a set of circumferentially-expandable struts **675** having a zig-zag or undulating shape forming a repeating “V” shape. The struts **675** can form a generally-cylindrical portion of the frame **600** with the upper portion of the struts **675** having a radial dimension which is about the same as the radial dimension as the lower portion of the struts **675**.

(138) The cells **660b**, **660c** may provide a foreshortening portion of the frame **600**. The illustrated

diamond or generally-diamond shape can be formed via a combination of struts. The upper portion of cells **660b** can be formed from the set of circumferentially-expansible struts **675** such that cells **660b** share struts with cells **660a**. The lower portion of cells **660b** can be formed from a set of circumferentially-expansible struts **680**. The circumferentially-expansible struts **680** can incorporate the bend **632** such that an upper portion of the struts **680** form a generally-cylindrical portion of the frame **600** and the lower portion of the struts **680** can be inclined or curved towards the longitudinal axis of the frame **600**. The upper portion of cells **660c** can be formed from the set of circumferentially-expansible struts **680** such that cells **660c** share struts with cells **660b**. The lower portion of cells **660c** can be formed from a set of circumferentially-expansible struts **685**. The circumferentially-expansible struts **685** can be inclined or curved towards the longitudinal axis of the frame **600**.

(139) The anchoring feature **640** can include one or more anchors. For example, as shown in the illustrated embodiment, the anchoring feature **640** can include twelve anchors. Each anchor can include one or more struts **642** extending from an upper region **610** of the frame body **602**. As shown, struts **642** extend into the cells **660a**. In some embodiments, the struts **642** extend from an upper intersection of two segments of the cell **660a**, for example, from the uppermost corner of the cells **660a** between struts **665**. The struts **642** can extend generally downwardly into the cells **660a** while curving outwards away from the frame body **602**. The anchoring feature **640** extends radially outwardly from the frame body **602** as it extends generally downwardly towards a tip **644**.

(140) The anchoring feature **640** can include one or more eyelets that form a portion of the tip **644** of the anchoring feature **640** that can be used to attach other components of the prosthesis in which the frame **600** is used. The anchoring feature **650** can include one or more anchors. Each anchor can include one or more struts **652** extending from a lower region **630** of the frame **600**.

(141) The struts **652** may extend generally downwardly while curving inwardly towards the longitudinal axis from the frame **600**. The struts **652** can incorporate a bend **654** to orient the strut **652** such that it extends radially outward away from the longitudinal axis of the frame **600**. The bend **654** can be generally semi-circular or semi-elliptical which can provide a space for the distal ends of the native valve leaflets to be held/stored. The anchors may then extend in a linear segment radially outwardly and upwardly. The struts **652** can include a second bend **656** along the linear segment that can orient the strut **652** such that it extends generally parallel to the longitudinal axis of the frame **600**. In some embodiments, each of the anchoring features **640**, **650** are positioned or extend generally radially outwardly from the frame **600** so that the anchor tips **644**, **658** are generally spaced away or radially outward from the rest of the frame body **602** and from where the base of the anchors connect to the frame body **602**.

(142) Individual anchors may extend radially outwardly from the frame at an anchor base and terminate at an anchor tip. The individual anchors can be connected to the frame at one of many different locations including apices, junctions, other parts of struts, etc. Further details that may be incorporated and/or interchanged with the features described herein are disclosed in U.S.

Publication Nos. 2014/0277422, 2014/0277427, 2014/0277390, and 2015/0328000, which are incorporated by reference herein for all purposes. Although a particular embodiment of a mitral valve frame is shown in FIGS. 23-25, it should be understood that the fiber-application processes and devices disclosed herein apply to other types of frames as well, including frames comprising rigid rings, spirally-wound tubes, and other tubes that fit within, for example, a heart valve annulus and that define an orifice therethrough for the passage of blood.

(143) FIG. 24 shows the heart valve frame **600** disposed on a holder **679**, such as an arm-type holder as described herein. Although an arm holder is shown in FIG. 24, it should be understood that any type of holder may be used to hold the valve frame **600**, including cylindrical or other-shaped spacer-type holders or other attachment features, as described herein. The mandrel **673** and holder **679** may be part of a collector assembly **670**, as described in detail herein.

(144) With the valve frame **600** disposed on the holder **679**, the mandrel **673** and coupled holder

679 can be rotated about the axis defined by the mandrel **673**. For example, the collector assembly **670** can comprise a rotor motor configured to rotate the mandrel **673**. The various components of the collector assembly **670** may be controlled at least in part by control circuitry of a local and/or remote controller system.

(145) Fibrous material may be applied to the valve frame **600** using a rotary jet spinning deposition system, which may be similar in certain respects to the system **800** shown in FIGS. **8A** and **8B**. For example, a rotating reservoir containing a solution may be rotated at sufficient speed to eject/expel a plane of fibrous strand(s), as shown in FIGS. **8A** and **8B**. The fibrous strand(s) can be applied to at least a portion of the outer surface of the frame **600** to form one or more layers of fibrous material, as shown in FIG. **25**.

(146) Fibrous material may be applied to at least a portion of the frame **600** in order to provide covering and/or cushioning for the valve implant device. In some implementations, rotary jet spinning may be used to apply fibrous material in a manner so as to surround or partially surround or cover at least a portion of the first anchoring feature **640** and/or the second anchoring feature **650**, such as the tips or ends **644** of the first anchoring feature **640** and/or the tips or ends **658** of the second anchoring feature **650** and/or the struts to which the tips or ends **644**, **658** are attached.

(147) In some implementations, one or more features of the frame **600** may be straightened-out at one or more points in the fibrous-material-application process. For example, as shown in FIG. **24**, one or more anchor features, such as the anchor features **650**, can be straightened-out for application of fibrous material using rotary jet spinning on a backside of the anchor features.

(148) In some embodiments, additional cushioning may be applied to one or more features of the frame **600**, such that the applied fibrous material forms a layer covering the cushioning. For example, the cushioning can be formed of a foam material, such as a polymer foam, such that the cushioning is at least somewhat compliant. In some embodiments, the cushioning can be formed as a polymer molded insert. In some embodiments, the cushioning can be loosely coupled to the anchoring feature(s). In some embodiments, all of the anchors of the second anchoring feature **650** have cushioning applied thereto.

(149) The upper end of the strut **692** can include an enlarged head **694** feature, which may have a semi-circular or semi-elliptical shape, or any other form or shape. The end **694** and/or the strut **692** can serve as a locking tab and can include one or more eyelets at one or more locations. The locking tab features can be advantageously used with various types of delivery systems. For example, the shape of the struts **692** and the enlarged head **694** can be used to secure the frame **600** to a “slot-” based delivery system. In some implementations, the head portion (e.g., eyelet) **694** can be used to secure the frame **600** to a tether-type delivery system, which may utilize sutures, wires, or fingers to control delivery of the frame **600**. Such features can advantageously facilitate recapture and repositioning of the frame **600** in situ. In addition, or as alternative, to serving as locking tab features, the strut ends **694** may be used to secure the frame **600** to the holder **679**. For example, the strut heads **694** can be used to suture, clip, snap, hook, or otherwise secure the strut head(s) **694** to the arm(s) **679** or other feature(s) of the holder **679**.

(150) FIG. **25** shows a heart valve device **601** having fibrous material applied to portions thereof using rotary jet spinning in accordance with one or more embodiments of the present disclosure. The valve body preferably includes a plurality of valve leaflets **662**. The plurality of valve leaflets **662** can function in a manner similar to the native mitral valve, or to any other valves in the vascular system, as desired.

(151) Fibrous material **660** may be applied to one or more portions or components using rotary jet spinning, as described herein. For example, the fibrous material **660** can be applied to the exterior (and/or interior) of the frame **600**. In some embodiments, the fibrous material **660** extends from an upper region of the frame **600** towards a lower region of the frame. In some implementations, rotary jet spinning is used to apply fibrous material to the frame **600** between the radial features **640** and the base of the frame. In some implementations, fibrous material is applied to one or more

sides of anchors of the anchoring feature **650**. Application of the fibrous material **660** can beneficially enhance sealing along the lower region of the frame **600**. The fibrous material **660** can be applied such that a portion of the fibrous material positioned around a middle portion of the frame **600** is loose relative to an exterior of the frame. Variation in rotational and/or translational speed of the fibrous solution reservoir and/or collection assembly can be implemented to produce the desired thickness, looseness, and/or other characteristic(s) of the fibrous material applied to the frame **600**. In some implementations, sutures **6630** can wrap around struts of certain anchoring features and/or struts of the frame body to couple the anchor/frame features to the fibrous material **660**.

(152) Rotary jet spinning can be used to apply fibrous material having different sets of characteristics to different portions of the frame. For example, fibrous material having a first set of characteristics may be applied to the frame body **612**, whereas fibrous material having a second set of characteristics can be applied to the anchor features **650**. Processes of depositing the fibrous material can be performed as many times as desired and/or for the desired amount of time in order to produce the desired thickness and/or other characteristics of fibrous material. In order to produce the desired fibrous covering **660**, the rate of rotation of the rotary jet spinning reservoir and/or mandrel/holder, the rate of translation of the mandrel/holder, the angle and/or change in angle of the holder assembly may be controlled to produce the desired application of fibrous material.

(153) FIGS. **26-28** and the accompanying description relate to embodiments of another example type of medical implant device that can be covered at least in part by fibrous material using rotary jet spinning solutions as described herein. Specifically, FIGS. **26-28** illustrate an annuloplasty repair device **700** that includes one or more components or portions that can desirably be at least partially covered in fibrous material using rotary jet spinning processes, as described herein.

(154) FIG. **26** is a perspective view of an annuloplasty repair device **720** in accordance with one or more embodiments. The annuloplasty repair device **720** can be used to help restore and/or improve the functionality of a defective native valve. For example, the annuloplasty repair device **720** may be designed to for use with procedures to tighten or reinforce a native heart valve annulus, such as a mitral valve annulus. Generally, a heart valve annulus can widen and change from its normal shape as a result of enlargement of the heart and/or valve regurgitation conditions. Widening or malformation of the annulus can lead to failure of the valve leaflets to properly coapt. To repair a malformed or defective annulus, the annuloplasty repair device **720** can be secured to the valve annulus to reshape, reinforce, or tighten the annulus.

(155) The example annuloplasty repair device **720** can include an annuloplasty structure **722**, comprising a body portion **724**, a flexible contracting longitudinal member **730** (herein referred to as “contracting member” or “flexible member”), and/or an adjusting mechanism **740**. At least a portion of the body portion **724** can comprise a compressible material, such as a coiled element, as shown by way of illustration and not limitation. For example, the body portion **724** may comprise stent-like struts, or a braided mesh. The body portion **724** can define a lumen along the longitudinal axis of the annuloplasty structure **722**, which advantageously houses the adjustable contracting member **730**. The flexible contracting member **730** can comprise a wire, a ribbon, a rope, or a band. The flexible contracting member **730** can be coupled at a first end portion thereof to the adjusting mechanism **740** which is coupled to a first end **721** of the structure **722**. A second end portion of the flexible contracting member **730** can be coupled to a second end **723** of the annuloplasty structure **722**. In some embodiments, the flexible contracting member **730** has at least one free end portion. The flexible contracting member **730** together with the compressible element of the body portion **724** and the braided mesh surrounding the body portion **24** can impart flexibility to the annuloplasty structure.

(156) The body portion **724** can comprise a relatively flexible biocompatible material, such as nitinol, stainless steel, platinum iridium, titanium, expanded polytetrafluoroethylene (ePTFE), cobalt chrome, and/or braided polyester suture (e.g., TI-CRON suture, Medtronic). In some

embodiments, the body portion **724** is coated with PTFE (Polytetrafluoroethylene), or other material. In some embodiments, the body portion **724** comprises accordion-like compressible structures which facilitate proper cinching of the annulus when the annuloplasty structure **722** is contracted. The body portion **724**, when compressed while implanted around a valve annulus, can enable portions of the annuloplasty structure **722** to contract and/or conform to the configuration of the annulus. Thus, the compressible features of the body portion **724** can facilitate contraction of the annulus in response to contraction of the annuloplasty structure **722**.

(157) In FIG. **26**, the annuloplasty structure **722** is shown in a partially-contracted state, such that the axis of the structure **722** is at least partially non-linear. For example, in response to rotation or other actuation of the adjustment component **740**, a portion of the contracting member **730** can be wrapped around a spool (not shown), or otherwise adjusted to effectively shorten the portion of the flexible member disposed within the annuloplasty structure **722**. Accordingly, the second end of the flexible contracting member **730** can be pulled toward the adjustment mechanism **740**, thereby pulling the second end **723** of the structure **722** toward first end **721** of the structure **722**.

(158) FIG. **27** shows the annuloplasty repair device **720** disposed on a holder **779**, such as an arm- or clip-type holder as described herein. Although a clip/arm holder is shown in FIG. **27**, it should be understood that any type of holder may be used to hold the annuloplasty repair device **720**, including cylindrical or other-shaped spacer-type holders or other attachment features, as described herein. The mandrel **773** and holder **779** may be part of a collector assembly **770**, as described in detail herein.

(159) The annuloplasty repair device **720** may be in an at least partially straightened-out configuration, as shown in FIG. **27** when fibrous material is applied thereto using rotary jet spinning. With the annuloplasty repair device **720** disposed on the holder **779**, the mandrel **773** and coupled holder **779** can be rotated about the axis defined by the mandrel **773**. For example, the collector assembly **770** can comprise or be mechanically coupled to a rotor motor configured to rotate the mandrel **773**. The various components of the collector assembly **770** may be controlled at least in part by control circuitry of a local and/or remote controller system.

(160) Fibrous material may be applied to the annuloplasty repair device **720** using a rotary jet spinning deposition system, which may be similar in certain respects to the system **800** shown in FIGS. **8A** and **8B**. For example, a rotating reservoir containing a solution may be rotated at sufficient speed to eject/expel a plane of fibrous strand(s), as shown in FIGS. **8A** and **8B**. The fibrous strand(s) can be applied to at least a portion of the annuloplasty structure **722** (e.g., coils **724**) to form one or more layers of fibrous material.

(161) FIG. **28** shows a perspective view of an annuloplasty repair device **710** having fibrous material **701** applied thereto using rotary jet spinning in accordance with one or more embodiments of the present disclosure. In some examples, the fibrous material **701** can be porous such that the fibrous material is at least partially permeable to blood flow. For example, the fibrous material **701** can comprise openings of any suitable or desirable dimensions. In order to produce the desired fibrous covering **701**, the rate of rotation of the rotary jet spinning reservoir and/or mandrel/holder, the rate of translation of the mandrel/holder, the angle and/or change in angle of the holder assembly may be controlled to produce the desired application of fibrous material.

(162) In FIG. **28**, the annuloplasty repair device is shown in an at least partially contracted/rounded state. In some embodiments, the annuloplasty repair device **710** can be configured to move between the straightened configuration of FIG. **27** and the contracted configuration of FIG. **28** by shortening an internal cable or other suture or device connected between one end **702** of the device **710** and the opposite end **702** of the device **710**.

(163) FIGS. **29-31** and the accompanying description relate to embodiments of another example type of medical implant device that can be covered at least in part by fibrous material using rotary jet spinning solutions as described herein. Specifically, FIGS. **29-31** illustrate a docking device **820** that includes one or more components or portions that can desirably be at least partially covered in

fibrous material using rotary jet spinning processes as described herein.

(164) Docking devices covered in fibrous material using rotary jet spinning in accordance with embodiments of the present disclosure can be configured for implantation in the body or a circulatory vessel/chamber of the body (e.g., a heart, native heart valve, blood vessel, vasculature, artery, vein, aorta, inferior vena cava (IVC), superior vena cava (SVC), pulmonary artery, aortic valve, pulmonary valve, mitral valve, tricuspid valve, etc.). Such devices can include at least one sealing portion, frame, and/or valve seat. The docking device **820** (see FIG. **31**) and its frame **810** can be configured or shaped to conform to a shape of a portion of the body in which it is to be implanted, such as to a shape of an aorta, pulmonary artery, IVC, or SVC. Further, whether the anatomy is varied or more uniform, docking devices and/or associated frames applicable to embodiments disclosed herein can be configured such that, when expanded inside the target vessel, the majority of the docking station contacts an interior surface of the vessel and distributes the pressure and force exerted by the docking device over the portion or length of the docking station in contact with the interior surface. This can be helpful, for example, in treating aortic insufficiency caused by an enlarging of the aortic valve and/or aorta.

(165) FIG. **29** is a perspective view of a frame **810** for a docking device in accordance with one or more embodiments of the present disclosure. The frame includes legs **850** for supporting a valve seat **818** or forming a portion of a valve seat. The valve seat **818** can comprise a separate component that is attached to the legs **850** or can be integrally formed with the legs **850**. In some implementations, the valve seat **818** is replaced/integrated with a valve device and the docking device **820** and valve device are configured and deployed as a single unit.

(166) The frame **810**, which is advantageously at least partially expandable, can provide the shape of a sealing portion **811**, the valve seat **818**, and/or the retaining portion **814**. The frame **810** can take a wide variety of different forms. In some implementations, the frame **810** has an end **862** having an inside diameter defined by the valve seat **818** and an outside diameter defined by an annular or cylindrical outer wall **868** of the retaining portion **814**.

(167) The valve seat **818** can be formed by an annular wall **18** that extends downward from the inside diameter of the sealing portion **811**. The frame **810** may be formed from an expandable lattice, as shown. The expandable lattice can be made in a variety of ways, such as with individual wires connected to form the lattice. In some implementations, the lattice is formed by braiding a suitable material. Alternatively, the lattice may be cut from a sheet and then rolled or otherwise formed into the shape of the expandable frame, molded, cut from a cylindrical tube, or formed in other way(s) or combination of the processes listed.

(168) In some embodiments, the frame **810** is made from a relatively flexible metal, metal alloy, or polymer. Examples of metals and metal alloys that can be used include, but are not limited to, nitinol and other shape memory alloys, cobalt-chromium (e.g., ELGILOY alloy), and stainless steel, but other metals and resilient or compliant non-metal materials can be used to make the frame **810**. These materials can allow the frame to be compressed to a small size, and then when the compression force is released, the frame can self-expand back to its pre-compressed diameter and/or the frame can be expanded by inflation of a device/balloon positioned inside the frame. The frame **850** can also be made of other materials and/or be expandable and collapsible in different ways, including but not limited to mechanically-expandable, balloon-expandable, self-expandable, or a combination of these.

(169) The sealing portion **811** can have fibrous material applied thereto, such as using rotary jet spinning in accordance with processes disclosed herein. The sealing portion **811** can take any form that prevents or inhibits the flow of blood from flowing around the outside surface of a valve mounted to the docking device. In some embodiments, the fibrous material applied to the sealing portion **811** can extend to and/or over the valve seat **818**. The fibrous material **821** can extend radially outward, covering the end **862** of the frame **810** and/or can extend longitudinally to cover at least a portion of the annular outer portion or wall **814**. The sealing portion **811** can provide a

seal between the docking device **820** and an interior surface of the target vessel. That is, the sealing portion **811** and the associated valve (when in a closed state) can substantially prevent or inhibit blood from flowing in the inflow direction.

(170) The valve seat **818** can be formed from a portion of the frame **810** or can be formed separately from the frame **810**. The valve seat **818** can take any form that provides a supporting surface for implanting or deploying a valve implant device in the docking device **800** when the docking device is expanded. The valve seat can optionally be reinforced with a reinforcing material (e.g., fibrous material from a rotary jet spinning system, a suture, wire, band, collar, etc. that can circumscribe the valve seat or a portion of the valve seat).

(171) The retaining portion(s) **814** can take a variety of different forms. For example, the retaining portion(s) **814** can include any structure that sets the position of the docking device **800** in the target vessel or chamber. For example, the retaining portion(s) **814** can press against or into the inside tissue surface and/or contour/extend around anatomical structures of the target vessel(s) to set and maintain the position of the docking device **800**. The retaining portion(s) **814** can be part of or define a portion of the body and/or sealing portion of the docking station **820** or can be a separate component that is attached to the body of the docking device.

(172) The retaining portion **814** can have an elongated form to allow a relatively small force to be applied to a large area of the target tissue, while a valve mounted to the docking device **800** can apply a relatively large force to the valve seat **818**. Applying a small radially-outward force over a larger area can be sufficient to securely hold the docking station in place, which can allow the docking station to conform to the unique shape/size of the anatomy and avoid/reduce the likelihood of damaging relatively weaker native tissue. The frame **810** (e.g., the retaining portion **814**) may be formed of struts **801**, which can have varying thickness. For example, reduced thickness in some area can advantageously allow for bending or flexing more easily. In some embodiments, the frame **810** is configured such that, when implanted, all or most of the outer surface of the docking station or frame contacts the interior surface of the target blood vessel (even when irregular or varied in shape). This also helps avoid/reduce the likelihood of damaging relatively weaker native tissue (e.g., by having too much localized force and/or pressure in one, two, or more particular locations).

(173) FIG. **30** shows the docking device frame **810** disposed on a holder **879**, such as a cylinder-type spacer form as described herein. Although a cylinder-type holder is shown in FIG. **30**, it should be understood that any type of holder may be used to hold the valve frame **810**, including arm-type holders or other attachment features, as described herein. The mandrel **873** and holder **879** may be part of a collector assembly **870**, as described in detail herein.

(174) With the valve frame **810** disposed on the holder **879**, the mandrel **873** and coupled holder **879** can be rotated about the axis defined by the mandrel **873**. For example, the collector assembly **870** can comprise a rotor motor configured to rotate the mandrel **873**. The various components of the collector assembly **870** may be controlled at least in part by control circuitry of a local and/or remote controller system.

(175) Fibrous material may be applied to the frame **810** using a rotary jet spinning deposition system, which may be similar in certain respects to the system **800** shown in FIGS. **8A** and **8B**. For example, a rotating reservoir containing a solution may be rotated at sufficient speed to eject/expel a plane of fibrous strand(s), as shown in FIGS. **8A** and **8B**. The fibrous strand(s) can be applied to at least a portion of the outer surface of the frame **810** to form one or more layers of fibrous material, as shown in FIG. **31**.

(176) Fibrous material may be applied to at least a portion of the frame **810** in order to provide a sealing covering for the docking device **820**. In some implementations, rotary jet spinning may be used to apply fibrous material in a manner so as to cover at least a portion of the end struts **862**, such as the tips or ends **844**, which may serve as the valve seat when the struts **862** are bent inward, as shown in FIG. **31**.

(177) In some implementations, one or more features of the frame **810** may be straightened-out at

one or more points in the fibrous-material-application process. For example, as shown in FIG. 30, the end struts **862** can be straightened-out for application of fibrous material using rotary jet spinning.

(178) FIG. 31 shows a perspective view of a docking device **820** having fibrous material **821** applied to at least a portion thereof in accordance with embodiments of the present disclosure. The frame **810** can have rotary-jet-spun fibrous material **821** applied on an end **862** of the frame **810** to effectuate a seal between a valve and interior surface of the target blood vessel when the valve is disposed in the valve seat **818** of the frame **810** and the frame **810** is radially expanded and placed in the target blood vessel. As applied, the fibrous material **821** can form a cylinder that appears rolled over the end **862** of the frame **810**.

(179) In some implementations, after the fibrous material **821** has been applied, the fibrous material **821** can be secured to the frame **810** in some manner. For example, the fibrous material **821** can be attached to the frame **810** with sutures, adhered, tied, fused, or the like. The fibrous material **821** can be deposited onto the end **862** of the frame **810**. In some embodiments, the end of the fibrous material **821** abuts the end **862** of the frame **810**. The inside diameter of the fibrous material **821** can advantageously be radially inward of and adjacent to the inside diameter of the frame **810**. The outside diameter the fibrous material **821** can be radially outward of and adjacent to the outside diameter of the frame **810**. The proximal surface of the fibrous material **821** can extend around a portion of the retaining portions **814** of the frame **810**. In some embodiments, the outside diameter of the fibrous material covering provides a secure fit and/or seal between the frame **810** and the interior tissue surface of the target blood vessel.

(180) The fibrous material **821** can be applied using rotary jet spinning entirely around the end **862** of the frame **810**. The fibrous material **821** can have contours or otherwise undulate between the struts **801** of the frame **810** or the fibrous material **821** can be flush with the end **862** of the frame **810**. The valve seat **818** can be defined by the inside diameter of the frame **810** and the inside diameter of the fibrous material **821**. In such a configuration, the fibrous material **821** can effectuate a continuous seal between the outside diameter of the frame **810** and the interior surface of the target blood vessel and between the inside diameter of the frame **810** and a prosthetic valve device. As mentioned above, the docking device **820** can be adapted for use at a variety of different positions in the circulatory system, such as the aorta. In order to produce the desired fibrous covering **821**, the rate of rotation of the rotary jet spinning reservoir and/or mandrel/holder, the rate of translation of the mandrel/holder, the angle and/or change in angle of the holder assembly may be controlled to produce the desired application of fibrous material.

(181) FIGS. 32-34 and the accompanying description relate to embodiments of another example type of docking device **1000** that can be covered at least in part by fibrous material using rotary jet spinning solutions as described herein. In some embodiments, the docking device frame **1000** of FIGS. 32 and 33 is suitable for use as a dock for a prosthetic heart valve, such as a transcatheter heart valve (e.g., aortic heart valve implant).

(182) The docking device of FIGS. 32-34 comprises a frame **1010**, which may be made at least in part of self-expanding memory metal (e.g., nitinol). The assembled/fabricated docking device **1000** (see FIG. 34) can be configured to be fixed inside a target vessel or chamber of the cardiac/circulatory system, such as the aortic root, to assist in annular fixation of a medical implant device, such as a transcatheter heart valve. The docking device **1000** may advantageously combine with a stent or other component of the heart valve implant to entrap native valve leaflets associated with the target vessel/chamber. The docking device **1000** may be used to anchor self-expanding and/or balloon-expanding implant devices therein.

(183) The docking device **1000** may be implanted in any suitable or desirable medical process, such as a median sternotomy and left ventricular puncture followed by snaring and externalization of a wire from the femoral artery, wherein the docking device **1000** and anchored heart valve can be introduced from the femoral artery and apex on the wire. Alternatively, the docking device **1000**

may be implanted using a fully-percutaneous approach through the femoral arteri(es).

(184) The docking device **1000** can be used to secure a prosthetic heart valve within a native heart valve. Although use of docking devices in accordance with the present disclosure are described as being used to secure a transcatheter heart valve in the aortic valve or the mitral valve of a heart, it should be understood that the disclosed docking devices can be configured for use with any other heart valve as well. The frame **1010** includes a plurality prongs/arms **1028** (three in the illustrated embodiment) attached to respective peaks of the strut(s) **1020** of the frame **1010**.

(185) FIG. **33** shows the docking device frame **1010** disposed on a holder **1018**, such as an arm-type holder as described herein. Although an arm holder is shown in FIG. **33**, it should be understood that any type of holder may be used to hold the docking device frame **1010**, including cylindrical or other-shaped spacer-type holders or other attachment features, as described herein. The mandrel **1019** and holder **1018** may be part of a collector assembly **1017**, as described in detail herein.

(186) With the docking device frame **1010** disposed on the holder **1018**, the mandrel **1019** and coupled holder **1018** can be rotated about the axis defined by the mandrel **673**. For example, the collector assembly **1017** can comprise a rotor motor configured to rotate the mandrel **1019**. The various components of the collector assembly **1017** may be controlled at least in part by control circuitry of a local and/or remote controller system.

(187) Fibrous material may be applied to the docking device frame **1010** using a rotary jet spinning deposition system, which may be similar in certain respects to the system **800** shown in FIGS. **8A** and **8B**. For example, a rotating reservoir containing a solution may be rotated at sufficient speed to eject/expel a plane of fibrous strand(s), as shown in FIGS. **8A** and **8B**. The fibrous strand(s) can be applied to at least a portion of the outer surface of the frame **1010** to form one or more layers of fibrous material, as shown in FIG. **25**.

(188) Fibrous material may be applied to at least a portion of the frame **1010** in order to provide covering for the docking device implant **1000**. In some implementations, rotary jet spinning may be used to apply fibrous material in a manner so as to surround or partially surround or cover at least a portion of the struts **1020** of the frame **1010**.

(189) The retaining arms **1028** can be used to help position and deploy the docking device **1000** into its proper location relative to the native aortic valve. The retaining arms **1028** eyelets/apertures therein, as shown. The upper/proximal end/peak of one or more of the struts **1020** can attach and/or be integrated with the retaining arms **1028**. The retaining arms **1028** can be advantageously used with various types of delivery systems. For example, the shape of the arms **1028**, which may have an enlarged head that can be used to secure the frame **1010** to a “slot-” based delivery system. In some implementations, the head portion (e.g., eyelet) of the arms **1028** can be used to secure the frame **1010** to a tether-type delivery system, which may utilize sutures, wires, or fingers to control delivery of the frame **1010**. Such features can advantageously facilitate recapture and repositioning of the frame **1010** in situ. In addition, or as an alternative, the arm features **1028** may be used to secure the frame **1010** to the holder **1018** of the collection assembly **1017** of a rotary jet spinning system. For example, the heads **1029** can be used to suture, clip, snap, hook, or otherwise secure the strut head(s) **1029** to the arm(s) or other feature(s) of the holder **1018**.

(190) FIG. **34** shows a docking device **1000** having fibrous material **1022** applied to portions thereof using rotary jet spinning in accordance with one or more embodiments of the present disclosure. Fibrous material **1022** may be applied to one or more portions or components of the device **1000** using rotary jet spinning in any suitable or desirable manner. For example, the fibrous material **1022** can be applied to the exterior (and/or interior) of the frame **1010**. In some embodiments, the fibrous material **1022** extends from upper ends of the frame struts **1020** to lower ends thereof. Application of the fibrous material can beneficially enhance sealing characteristics of the device **1000**. Rotary jet spinning can be used to apply fibrous material having different sets of characteristics to different portions of the frame **1010**. Processes of depositing the fibrous material

can be performed as many times as desired and/or for the desired amount of time in order to produce the desired thickness and/or other characteristics of fibrous material. In order to produce the desired fibrous covering **1022**, the rate of rotation of the rotary jet spinning reservoir and/or mandrel/holder, the rate of translation of the mandrel/holder, the angle and/or change in angle of the holder assembly may be controlled to produce the desired application of fibrous material. (191) FIGS. **35** and **36** and the respective accompanying description relate to embodiments of other example types of docking devices that can be covered at least in part by fibrous material using rotary jet spinning solutions as described herein. In some embodiments, the docking devices **930**, **940** of FIGS. **35** and **36** may be suitable for use as docks for prosthetic heart valves, such as a transcatheter heart valves (e.g., aortic).

(192) The docking device **930** of FIG. **35** includes a support stent or frame **931** that can be used to help secure a heart valve implant into the interior of a native heart valve, such as an aortic valve. The frame **931** can have a generally annular or toroidal body formed from a suitable shape-memory metal or alloy, such as spring steel, cobalt-chromium (e.g., ELGILOY alloy), or nitinol. The frame **931** can be radially compressible to a smaller profile and can self-expand when deployed into its functional size and shape. In some embodiments, the frame **931** is not self-expanding.

(193) The support frame **931** includes a generally cylindrical main body portion **932** and a rim portion **933**. The frame **931** can be a lattice structure, which can be formed, for example, from multiple struts in which approximately half of the struts are angled in a first direction and approximately half of the struts are angled in a second direction, thereby creating a crisscross or diamond-shaped pattern. In the illustrated embodiment, the rim portion **933** has a greater diameter than the main body portion **932** and is formed as an extension at a bottom region of the main body portion that is folded outwardly from the main body portion and back toward a top region of the main body portion. The rim portion **933** can thus form a U-shaped rim or lip around the bottom region of the frame **910**. In general, the rim portion **933** can be designed to have a diameter that is slightly larger than the walls of the aortic arch that surround the aortic valve. Thus, when the frame **910** is delivered to the aortic valve and deployed at the aorta, the rim portion **933** can expand to engage the surrounding aorta wall and frictionally secure the frame **910**. At the same time, the main body portion **932** can define an interior into which an expandable heart valve implant (not shown) can be expanded and which further engages the native leaflets of, for example, the aortic valve. (194) The frame **931** can further include retaining arms **934** that can be used to help position and deploy the frame **910** into its proper location relative to the native valve. The retaining arms **934** can have apertures associated therewith, which may be used for various purposes, including to couple the frame **931** to a holder device for a rotary jet spinning system, as described in detail herein.

(195) The frame **931** can have fibrous material **935** applied to portions thereof using rotary jet spinning in accordance with one or more embodiments of the present disclosure. Fibrous material **935** may be applied to one or more portions or components of the device **930** using rotary jet spinning in any suitable or desirable manner. For example, the fibrous material **935** can be applied to the exterior (and/or interior) of the frame **931**. In some embodiments, the fibrous material **935** extends from upper ends of the frame struts of the body portion **932** to end of the rim portion **933**. Application of the fibrous material can beneficially enhance sealing characteristics of the device **930**. Rotary jet spinning can be used to apply fibrous material having different sets of characteristics to different portions of the frame **931**. Processes of depositing the fibrous material **935** can be performed as many times as desired and/or for the desired amount of time in order to produce the desired thickness and/or other characteristics of fibrous material. In order to produce the desired fibrous covering **935**, the rate of rotation of the rotary jet spinning reservoir and/or mandrel/holder, the rate of translation of the mandrel/holder, the angle and/or change in angle of the holder assembly may be controlled to produce the desired application of fibrous material.

(196) FIG. **36** shows a valved conduit **940** including a conduit graft **942** that is integrated with a

prosthetic valve implant device **941** (partially obscured within conduit graft **942** in FIG. **36**). Together, the conduit **942** and the valve device **941** form a two-piece valved conduit assembly. The conduit graft **942** can be configured to facilitate replacement of a previously-implanted prosthetic valve implant device. That is, a heart valve **941** within a valved conduit **940** can sometimes become calcified and must be replaced. The combination **940** can provide for relatively easy valve removal.

(197) In some implementations, the conduit graft **942** can be used as an aortic conduit graft, for example. As shown, the prosthetic heart valve **941** can be positioned at least partially within one end of the conduit graft **942**. The valved conduit **940** can be used for replacing a native aortic valve and/or ascending aorta. However, it should be understood that certain principles disclosed herein would also apply to replacement of the pulmonary valve and the pulmonary artery.

(198) The heart valve **941** may include a rigid or semi-rigid stent supporting a plurality of flexible leaflets (not shown) that are mounted to the peripheral stent structure and form fluid occluding surfaces within the valve orifice to form a one-way valve. The frame structure can include a plurality of generally axially extending commissures, circumferentially distributed around the valve between and in the same number as the number of leaflets, as described in detail above. The valve orifice can be oriented around an axis along an inflow-outflow direction through the valve **941**.

FIG. **36** shows a sewing ring component of the valve **941** exposed beyond the conduit graft **942** on the inflow end thereof, which may conform to the undulating contours of the valve cusps, or define a generally circular, planar ring.

(199) The conduit graft **942** may define a generally tubular structure that extends from an inflow end **943** to an outflow end (not shown). In the embodiment shown, the valve **941** is associated with the conduit graft **941** in such a way that the valve leaflets control flow of blood through the conduit by permitting blood flow into the conduit (e.g., blood flow into the aorta, when the conduit is used for aortic replacement) while preventing flow of blood out of the conduit in the opposite direction (e.g., back into the left ventricle of the patient when used for aortic replacement).

(200) The illustrated conduit graft **942** is particularly suited for attachment within the aortic annulus and ascending aorta, and as such can closely match the aortic root anatomy and include an enlarged region or bulge **944** close to the inflow end **943** that conforms to the sinuses of Valsalva just above the aortic annulus. The conduit graft **942** can have fibrous material **945** applied thereto using rotary jet spinning in accordance with embodiments of the present disclosure. In some implementations, the fibrous material **945** can be sealed with a bioresorbable medium such as gelatin or collagen. The form of at least a portion of the conduit graft **942** can include circumferentially corrugated (e.g., grooved) or pleated sidewall portion(s) that provide longitudinal flexibility and/or radial compressibility while ensuring that the graft does not unduly radially expand under the pressure of blood flowing therethrough. The enlarged region or bulge **944** may be configured with longitudinal corrugations that are more radially expandable than the circumferential pleats to allow expansion at that location into the Valsalva sinuses. The conduit graft **942** may desirably have a length of from a few centimeters to 10-12 centimeters.

(201) The conduit graft **942** can have fibrous material **945** applied to portions thereof using rotary jet spinning in accordance with one or more embodiments of the present disclosure. Fibrous material **945** may be applied to one or more portions or components of the device **940** using rotary jet spinning in any suitable or desirable manner. For example, the fibrous material **945** can be applied to one or more portions of the exterior of the conduit graft **942**. In some embodiments, the fibrous material **945** extends from the outflow end of the conduit graft **942** to the end of the bulge portion **944**. Application of the fibrous material **945** can beneficially enhance sealing characteristics of the device **940**. Rotary jet spinning can be used to apply fibrous material having different sets of characteristics to different portions of the conduit graft **942**. Processes of depositing the fibrous material **945** can be performed as many times as desired and/or for the desired amount of time in order to produce the desired thickness and/or other characteristics of fibrous material. In order to

produce the desired fibrous covering **945**, the rate of rotation of the rotary jet spinning reservoir and/or mandrel/holder, the rate of translation of the mandrel/holder, the angle and/or change in angle of the holder assembly may be controlled to produce the desired application of fibrous material.

(202) FIG. **37** illustrates a septal closure device **160** including a blood occluding portion **161** formed at least in part of fibrous material **165** applied to a frame **162** using rotary jet spinning process(es) according to one or more embodiments of the present disclosure. The septal closure device **160** may be configured to be implanted in or to a septal wall to at least partially close a septal orifice. In some embodiments, the septal closure device **160** allows for re-entry through the septum at the same septal orifice location at a later time as other therapeutic interventions are warranted. In certain embodiments, the closure device **160** is configured to provide an access port for accessing the left side of the heart with a catheter or other medical device. In some implementations, the closure device **160** can be implanted in orifices formed in a ventricular septum, the apex or other sections of the heart, or in orifices (surgically or congenitally formed orifices) formed in other organs of the body.

(203) The septal closure device **160** can include a frame **162** configured to support the blood-occluding fibrous material **165**. The frame **162** in the illustrated configuration can comprise a generally planar body comprising a central portion **166** and a plurality of anchoring arms **163** extending radially outward from the central portion **166**. For example, at least four arms can extend from the central portion **166**, as shown in the illustrated embodiment, although the frame can have greater than four arms or less than four arms in other embodiments.

(204) The four arms **163** may include a first set of opposing distal arms **168**, and a second set of opposing proximal arms **169**, extending from the central portion **166**, as illustrated. The closure device desirably (although not necessarily) has the same number of arms in the first and second sets so that the clamping force exerted by the arms is evenly distributed against the septum when the device is implanted. In a deployed or expanded configuration, the arms **163** can extend radially outwardly from the central portion **166**. The arms **163** can extend perpendicularly or substantially perpendicularly to a central axis of the device **160** (the central axis extending orthogonal to the plane of the page) such that the septum wall can be compressed or pinched between the first set of arms **168** and the second set of arms **169** when the device **160** is implanted in the atrial septum. In other words, when the device **160** is implanted, the first set of arms **168** can be on one side of the atrial septum, the second set of arms **169** can be on the other side of the atrial septum, and the central portion **166** can be disposed within an orifice or defect or offset to one side of the septum.

(205) The frame **162** can have a relatively thin and flat profile to avoid or minimize thrombus risk. Thus, to such end, the arms **163** can be attached to the central portion **166** at angularly spaced apart locations on the central portion, with the attachment locations intersecting a common plane perpendicular to the central axis; in other words, all of the arms **163** in the illustrated embodiment can be attached to the central portion along the same circumferential path defined by the central portion **166**.

(206) Additionally, the arms **163** and the connecting frame portions **167** (covered by the fibrous material **165** in the illustrated configuration) of the illustrated frame **162** can collectively form a simple closed loop structure wherein a single continuous frame member forms each of the arms and the connecting portions. Each of the arms **163** can have a variety of shapes. For example, embodiments of the plurality of arms **163** may have a mushroom shape, a diamond shape, or a circular shape.

(207) The central portion **166** of the frame **162** can have the fibrous material **165** applied to portions thereof using rotary jet spinning in accordance with one or more embodiments of the present disclosure. Fibrous material **165** may be applied to one or more portions or components of the device **160** using rotary jet spinning in any suitable or desirable manner. For example, the fibrous material **165** can be applied to one or both sides of the central portion **166** using rotary jet

spinning. In some embodiments, the fibrous material **165** covers substantially the entire central portion **166**, as shown, or may alternatively only cover one or more bands or portions thereof. Application of the fibrous material can beneficially enhance occluding characteristics of the device **160**. Rotary jet spinning can be used to apply fibrous material having different sets of characteristics to different portions of the device **160**. Furthermore, processes of depositing the fibrous material **165** can be performed as many times as desired and/or for the desired amount of time in order to produce the desired thickness and/or other characteristics of fibrous material. In order to produce the desired fibrous covering **165**, the rate of rotation of the rotary jet spinning reservoir and/or mandrel/holder, the rate of translation of the mandrel/holder, the angle and/or change in angle of the holder assembly may be controlled to produce the desired application of fibrous material.

(208) FIG. **38** illustrates another embodiment of a docking device **1100** including fibrous material **1180** applied to portions thereof using rotary jet spinning in accordance with one or more embodiments. The docking device **1100** can be configured to can be used in conjunction with an expandable transcatheter heart valve at a native valve annulus (e.g., mitral or tricuspid valve annulus), in order to more securely implant and hold the prosthetic valve at the implant site.

Anchoring/docking devices according to embodiments of the present disclosure can provide or form a more circular and/or stable annulus at the implant site, in which prosthetic valves having circular or cylindrically-shaped valve frames or stents can be expanded or otherwise implanted. (209) In addition to providing an anchoring site for a prosthetic valve, the anchoring/docking device **1100** can be sized and shaped to cinch or draw the native valve (e.g., mitral, tricuspid, etc.) anatomy radially inwards. In this manner, one of the main causes of valve regurgitation (e.g., functional mitral regurgitation), specifically enlargement of the heart (e.g., left ventricle) and/or valve annulus, and consequent stretching out of the native valve (e.g., mitral) annulus, can be at least partially offset or counteracted. Some embodiments of the anchoring or docking device **1100** further include features which, for example, are shaped and/or modified to better hold a position or shape of the docking device during and/or after expansion of a prosthetic valve therein. By providing such anchoring or docking devices, replacement valves can be more securely implanted and held at various valve annuluses, including at the mitral annulus which does not have a naturally circular cross-section.

(210) The docking device **1100** can include a central region **1110**, a lower region **1120**, an upper region **1130**, and an extension region **1140**. In some embodiments, the lower and upper regions **1120**, **1130** can form larger coil diameters than the central region **1110**, and the extension region **1140** can space the upper region **1130** apart from the central region **1110** in a vertical direction.

(211) The central coils/turns **1110** of the docking device **1100** can provide a main docking site for a prosthetic valve that is expanded therein. The central turns **1110** can generally be positioned in the left ventricle, while a small distal portion, if any, may extend through the native valve annulus and into the left atrium. The central turns **1110** can be configured to sufficient force for stably holding the expanded valve implant in the docking device **1100** and preventing the valve from dislodging from the docking device **1100**, even during severe mitral pressures.

(212) The lower region **1120** of the docking device **1100** can serve as a leading coil/turn (e.g., a ventricular encircling turn). The lower region **1120** includes the distal tip of the docking device **1100** and flares radially outwardly from the central turns **1110** in order to capture the native valve leaflets, and some or all of the chordae and/or other mitral anatomy when the docking device **1100** is advanced into the left atrium.

(213) The upper region **1130** of the docking device **1100** can serve as the stabilization coil/turn (e.g., atrial coil/turn) that provides the docking device **1100** with a self-retention mechanism during the transition phase after the docking device **1100** is deployed at the native valve and prior to delivery of the THV. For example, the diameter of the upper region **1130** can be selected to allow the upper region **1130** to fit at an approximate desired height in the left atrium, and to prevent the

upper region **1130** from sliding or dropping further towards the native mitral annulus after the desired position is achieved.

(214) The extension region **1140** provides a vertical extension and spacing between the central region **1110** and the upper region **1130** of the docking device **1100**. The location at which the docking device **1100** crosses the mitral plane is important in preserving the integrity of the native valve anatomy, and specifically the valve leaflets and commissures, to serve as an appropriate docking site for the final implantation of the valve implant. In docking devices without such an extension or ascending region **1140**, more of the docking device would sit on or against the mitral plane and pinch against the native leaflets, and the relative motion or rubbing of the docking device against the native leaflets could potentially damage the native leaflets from the atrial side. Having an extension region **1140** allows the portion of the docking device **1100** that is positioned in the left atrium to ascend away and be spaced apart from the mitral plane.

(215) The docking device **1100** can include a low friction (e.g., ePTFE) cover layer **1170** that may improve interactions between the ends of the docking device **1100** and the native heart anatomy. For example, additional friction may be more desirable on at least a portion of the central region **1110**, which provides the functional coils of the docking device **1100** for docking the valve implant. Therefore, fibrous material **1180** can be applied to the central region **1110** of the docking device **1100** using rotary jet spinning process(es) in accordance with embodiments of the present disclosure. The fibrous material **1180** can provide additional friction between adjacent coils and against the native leaflets and/or valve implant device docked in the docking device **1100**. The friction that is provided by the fibrous material **1180** at the interfaces between coils and between the inner surface of the central region **1110** of the docking device **1100**, the native mitral leaflets, and/or the outer surface of the valve implant can create a more secure locking mechanism to more strongly anchor the valve device and the docking device **1100** to the native valve. Since the functional coils/turns or central region **1110** of the docking device **1100**, that is, the region of the docking device that interacts with the valve implant device, may be the only region where a high friction fibrous material/layer is desired, the fibrous material **1180** may be applied using rotary jet spinning selectively only to portion(s) of the central region **1110**, such that other regions remain low-friction in order to facilitate less traumatic interactions with the native valve and other heart anatomy.

(216) The docking device **1100** can have fibrous material **1180** applied to portions thereof using rotary jet spinning in accordance with one or more embodiments of the present disclosure. Fibrous material **1180** may be applied to one or more portions or components of the device **1100** using rotary jet spinning in any suitable or desirable manner. For example, the fibrous material **1180** can be applied to one or more portions of the exterior and/or interior of the coils **1110** and/or other portions of the docking device **1100**. Rotary jet spinning can be used to apply fibrous material having different sets of characteristics to different portions of the docking device **1100**. Processes of depositing the fibrous material **1180** can be performed as many times as desired and/or for the desired amount of time in order to produce the desired thickness and/or other characteristics of fibrous material. In order to produce the desired fibrous covering **1180**, the rate of rotation of the rotary jet spinning reservoir and/or mandrel/holder, the rate of translation of the mandrel/holder, the angle and/or change in angle of the holder assembly may be controlled to produce the desired application of fibrous material.

(217) FIG. **39** illustrates a tissue anchor device **1200** including fibrous material **1245** applied to portions thereof using rotary jet spinning in accordance with one or more embodiments. The device **1200** may be used for medical treatment and/or treating heart conditions, including, by way of example, treating dilation/dilatation (including a dilated left ventricle), valve incompetence (including mitral valve regurgitation), and other similar heart failure conditions. In some implementations, the device **1200** operates to assist in an apposition of heart valve leaflets so as to improve valve function. In addition, the device **1200** may either be placed in conjunction with other

devices that are configured to alter the shape or geometry of the heart, locally and/or globally, and thereby further increase the heart's efficiency. That is, the device **1200** may function alone or in concert with one or more other implant devices to facilitate an increased pumping efficiency of the heart by way of an alteration in the heart's shape or geometry and concomitant reduction in stress on heart walls, and through an improvement in valve function.

(218) In some implementations, the anchor device **1200** suitable for fixating a mitral valve splint device within the heart and/or left atrium. The anchor **1200** may be self-expandable and may comprise a ring **1252** which may peripherally support a cover portion **1256** that is covered at least in part with fibrous material **1245** using rotary jet spinning in accordance with embodiments of the present disclosure. Upon cinching a centrally disposed tension member or cord **1260**, the cover **1256** can assume a circular, flattened, disc-shaped, or pie-shaped configuration, as shown, e.g., when the interior ends of the tabs **1288** are pulled toward the center, or can assume a cone shaped configuration if the ends of the tabs **1288** are pulled in a direction perpendicular to a plane aligned with the ring **1252**, such as when the tension member pulls the anchor **1200** toward another anchor.

(219) The deployed or expanded configuration (e.g., circular/disc-shaped/pie-shaped/cone-shaped configuration) of the self-expandable anchor **1200** can be suited for anchoring a tension member in a position within the heart, such as the left atrium, as well as withstanding the forces encountered during changing the shape of the heart. Generally, a larger surface area of the cover portion **1256** can help the anchor **1200** withstand higher forces. For example, a relatively large surface area of the cover **1256** coupled with a centrally-disposed tension member **1260** can provide an inherently stable configuration of the anchor **1200**, thereby eliminating or reducing the risk of mechanical failures and migration into the tissue as encountered with certain other anchors. Further, where the cover **1256** has a relatively large surface area and the tension member **1260** is associated with the center of the device, as shown, the device **1200** can operate as a closure device which seals the punctures in the walls of the heart or other anatomy. In some implementations, the fibrous material **1245** is applied in a manner as to form a generally conical shape configuration when placed under tension so as to inhibit migration of the anchor during beating of the heart.

(220) The anchor device **12100** can have fibrous material **1245** applied to portions thereof using rotary jet spinning in accordance with one or more embodiments of the present disclosure. Fibrous material **1245** may be applied to one or more portions or components of the device **1200** using rotary jet spinning in any suitable or desirable manner. For example, the fibrous material **1245** can be applied to one or more portions of the cover **1256** and/or ring **1252**. Rotary jet spinning can be used to apply fibrous material having different sets of characteristics to different portions of the anchor device **1200**. Processes of depositing the fibrous material **1245** can be performed as many times as desired and/or for the desired amount of time in order to produce the desired thickness and/or other characteristics of fibrous material. In order to produce the desired fibrous material **1245**, the rate of rotation of the rotary jet spinning reservoir and/or mandrel/holder, the rate of translation of the mandrel/holder, the angle and/or change in angle of the holder assembly may be controlled to produce the desired application of fibrous material.

(221) FIG. **40** illustrates another embodiment of an annuloplasty repair device **1300** including fibrous material **1245** applied to portions thereof using rotary jet spinning in accordance with one or more embodiments. The annuloplasty repair device **1300** can be configured to restore the specific morphology and dynamic characteristics of heart valves damaged by various degenerative valvular disease to overcome some of the limitations of currently available rings is described.

(222) The annuloplasty repair device **1300** can be a semi-rigid ring device. The device **1300** can include a relatively rigid anterior side and a gradually more flexible posterior side to provide some flexibility to the ring while preserving its annular remodeling effect. The annuloplasty repair device **1300** can have fibrous material **1345** applied to portions thereof using rotary jet spinning in accordance with one or more embodiments of the present disclosure. Fibrous material **1345** may be applied to one or more portions or components of the device **1300** using rotary jet spinning in any

suitable or desirable manner. For example, the fibrous material **1345** can be applied to one or more inner or outer portions of the ring form of the device. Rotary jet spinning can be used to apply fibrous material having different sets of characteristics to different portions of the annuloplasty repair device **1300**. Processes of depositing the fibrous material **1345** can be performed as many times as desired and/or for the desired amount of time in order to produce the desired thickness and/or other characteristics of fibrous material. In order to produce the desired fibrous covering **1345**, the rate of rotation of the rotary jet spinning reservoir and/or mandrel/holder, the rate of translation of the mandrel/holder, the angle and/or change in angle of the holder assembly may be controlled to produce the desired application of fibrous material.

(223) FIG. **41** is a flow diagram for a process **1400** for applying fibrous material to a medical device component. At block **1402**, the process **1400** involves coupling a medical device component to a holder associated with a rotating mandrel. The holder and/or mandrel may be part of a collection assembly, as described herein. Furthermore, the holder may be a spacer-type or arm-type holder, as described in detail herein.

(224) At block **1404**, the process **1400** involves rotating a reservoir of a rotary jet spinning system to eject a plane of fibrous material, as described herein. For example, the reservoir can comprise a volume of polymeric solution that is ejected from one or more orifices in the reservoir when the reservoir is rotated at a sufficient speed. The reservoir device can be part of a deposition assembly.

(225) At block **1406**, the process **1400** involves rotating and/or translating the holder within/into the plane of ejected fibrous material using the mandrel and/or one or more other components of the collection assembly. The holder is advantageously rotated concurrently with the rotation of the reservoir. At block **1408**, the process **1400** involves continuing to rotate and/or translate the holder to produce a desired coating of fibrous material on one or more portions of the medical device component.

(226) The process **1400** may be performed at least in part by control circuitry coupled to the collection assembly and/or the deposition assembly.

ADDITIONAL EMBODIMENTS

(227) Depending on the embodiment, certain acts, events, or functions of any of the processes or algorithms described herein can be performed in a different sequence, may be added, merged, or left out altogether. Thus, in certain embodiments, not all described acts or events are necessary for the practice of the processes.

(228) Conditional language used herein, such as, among others, “can,” “could,” “might,” “may,” “e.g.,” and the like, unless specifically stated otherwise, or otherwise understood within the context as used, is intended in its ordinary sense and is generally intended to convey that certain embodiments include, while other embodiments do not include, certain features, elements and/or steps. Thus, such conditional language is not generally intended to imply that features, elements and/or steps are in any way required for one or more embodiments or that one or more embodiments necessarily include logic for deciding, with or without author input or prompting, whether these features, elements and/or steps are included or are to be performed in any particular embodiment. The terms “comprising,” “including,” “having,” and the like are synonymous, are used in their ordinary sense, and are used inclusively, in an open-ended fashion, and do not exclude additional elements, features, acts, operations, and so forth. Also, the term “or” is used in its inclusive sense (and not in its exclusive sense) so that when used, for example, to connect a list of elements, the term “or” means one, some, or all of the elements in the list. Conjunctive language such as the phrase “at least one of X, Y and Z,” unless specifically stated otherwise, is understood with the context as used in general to convey that an item, term, element, etc. may be either X, Y or Z. Thus, such conjunctive language is not generally intended to imply that certain embodiments require at least one of X, at least one of Y and at least one of Z to each be present.

(229) It should be appreciated that in the above description of embodiments, various features are sometimes grouped together in a single embodiment, Figure, or description thereof for the purpose

of streamlining the disclosure and aiding in the understanding of one or more of the various inventive aspects. This method of disclosure, however, is not to be interpreted as reflecting an intention that any claim require more features than are expressly recited in that claim. Moreover, any components, features, or steps illustrated and/or described in a particular embodiment herein can be applied to or used with any other embodiment(s). Further, no component, feature, step, or group of components, features, or steps are necessary or indispensable for each embodiment. Thus, it is intended that the scope of the inventions herein disclosed and claimed below should not be limited by the particular embodiments described above but should be determined only by a fair reading of the claims that follow.

(230) It should be understood that certain ordinal terms (e.g., “first” or “second”) may be provided for ease of reference and do not necessarily imply physical characteristics or ordering. Therefore, as used herein, an ordinal term (e.g., “first,” “second,” “third,” etc.) used to modify an element, such as a structure, a component, an operation, etc., does not necessarily indicate priority or order of the element with respect to any other element, but rather may generally distinguish the element from another element having a similar or identical name (but for use of the ordinal term). In addition, as used herein, indefinite articles (“a” and “an”) may indicate “one or more” rather than “one.” Further, an operation performed “based on” a condition or event may also be performed based on one or more other conditions or events not explicitly recited.

(231) Unless otherwise defined, all terms (including technical and scientific terms) used herein have the same meaning as commonly understood by one of ordinary skill in the art to which example embodiments belong. It be further understood that terms, such as those defined in commonly used dictionaries, should be interpreted as having a meaning that is consistent with their meaning in the context of the relevant art and not be interpreted in an idealized or overly formal sense unless expressly so defined herein.

(232) The spatially relative terms “outer,” “inner,” “upper,” “lower,” “below,” “above,” “vertical,” “horizontal,” and similar terms, may be used herein for ease of description to describe the relations between one element or component and another element or component as illustrated in the drawings. It be understood that the spatially relative terms are intended to encompass different orientations of the device in use or operation, in addition to the orientation depicted in the drawings. For example, in the case where a device shown in the drawing is turned over, the device positioned “below” or “beneath” another device may be placed “above” another device. Accordingly, the illustrative term “below” may include both the lower and upper positions. The device may also be oriented in the other direction, and thus the spatially relative terms may be interpreted differently depending on the orientations.

(233) Unless otherwise expressly stated, comparative and/or quantitative terms, such as “less,” “more,” “greater,” and the like, are intended to encompass the concepts of equality. For example, “less” can mean not only “less” in the strictest mathematical sense, but also, “less than or equal to.”

Claims

1. A method of applying fibrous material to a medical device component, the method comprising: coupling a surgical heart valve device to a holder device, the surgical heart valve device including: a non-expandable sealing ring; a plurality of commissure posts projecting in an outflow direction on an outflow side of the sealing ring; and an expandable skirt frame extending on an inflow side of the sealing ring; rotating a reservoir device to expel at least a portion of a first liquid polymeric solution from an orifice of the reservoir device, the expelled at least a portion of the first liquid polymeric solution forming one or more first strands of fibrous material in a first deposition plane; rotating the holder device at least partially within the first deposition plane to apply at least a portion of the one or more first strands of fibrous material to the sealing ring and the plurality of commissure posts of the surgical heart valve device, thereby forming a first fibrous covering

having a first set of characteristics on the sealing ring and the plurality of commissure posts; rotating the reservoir device to expel at least a portion of a second liquid polymeric solution from the orifice of the reservoir device, the expelled at least a portion of the second liquid polymeric solution forming one or more second strands of fibrous material in a second deposition plane; and rotating the holder device at least partially within the second deposition plane to apply at least a portion of the one or more second strands of fibrous material to the skirt frame of the surgical heart valve device, thereby forming a second fibrous covering having a second set of characteristics on the skirt frame.

2. The method of claim 1, wherein the holder device is a component of a collection assembly further comprising: a rotary motor; and a mandrel that is mechanically coupled to the holder device and the rotary motor.

3. The method of claim 2, further comprising translating the collection assembly along a vertical axis while expelling the at least a portion of the first liquid polymeric solution.

4. The method of claim 1, wherein the holder device is an at least partially cylindrical spacer form.

5. The method of claim 4, further comprising applying an additional portion of the one or more second strands of fibrous material to a surface of the holder device, thereby forming a surplus fibrous covering portion on the surface of the holder device.

6. The method of claim 5, further comprising: decoupling the surgical heart valve device from the holder device; and folding the surplus fibrous covering portion over an inflow edge of the skirt frame to cover at least a portion of an inside surface of the skirt frame.

7. The method of claim 1, wherein the holder device comprises a plurality of arms configured to be coupled to the skirt frame.

8. The method of claim 7, wherein said coupling the skirt frame to the holder device comprises suturing the skirt frame to the plurality of arms of the holder device.

9. The method of claim 1, wherein rotating the reservoir device and the holder device is performed at least in part using control circuitry communicatively coupled to a collection assembly associated with the holder device and a deposition assembly associated with the reservoir device.

10. The method of claim 1, wherein the holder device comprises an at least partially cylindrical spacer form.

11. The method of claim 10, wherein the spacer form has a non-uniform longitudinal diameter.

12. A method of applying fibrous material to a medical device, the method comprising: coupling a leaflet spacer device to a holder device, the leaflet spacer device including: a main spacer body and; a plurality of clip members configured to be movable to capture one or more leaflets of a heart valve between the plurality of clip members and the main spacer body; opening the plurality of clip members to a straightened-out configuration exposing inside surfaces of the main spacer body and the plurality of clip members; rotating a reservoir device to expel a first portion of fibrous material in a first deposition plane; and rotating the holder device at least partially within the first deposition plane to apply the first portion of fibrous material to the inside surfaces of the main spacer body and the plurality of clip members of the leaflet spacer device, thereby forming a fibrous covering on the inside surfaces of the main spacer body and the plurality of clip members.

13. The method of claim 12, further comprising: closing the plurality of clip members; and covering outside surfaces of at least a portion of the plurality of clip members with a second portion of fibrous material expelled from the reservoir device when the plurality of clip members are in a closed configuration.

14. The method of claim 12, wherein: the leaflet spacer device includes a hub member; and coupling the leaflet spacer device to the holder device involves clipping the holder device at least partially around the hub member.

15. The method of claim 12, further comprising transitioning the leaflet spacer device from the straightened-out configuration to a folded configuration after said forming the fibrous covering on the inside surfaces of the main spacer body and the plurality of clip members.

16. A method of applying fibrous material to a medical device component, the method comprising: coupling a holder device to a rotatable mandrel; coupling a prosthetic heart valve to the holder device, the prosthetic heart valve including: a sealing ring; a first frame including a plurality of commissure posts; and a second frame extending on an inflow side of the sealing ring; rotating a reservoir device to expel a first portion of liquid polymeric solution in a first deposition plane; rotating the holder device at least partially within the first deposition plane to apply the first portion of liquid polymeric solution to the sealing ring, thereby forming a first fibrous covering having a first set of characteristics on the sealing ring; rotating the reservoir device to expel a second portion of liquid polymeric solution in a second deposition plane; and rotating the holder device at least partially within the second deposition plane to apply the second portion of liquid polymeric solution to the second frame, thereby forming a second fibrous covering having a second set of characteristics that are different from the first set of characteristics on the second frame.
17. The method of claim 16, wherein: the holder device comprises a plurality of arms; and said coupling the prosthetic heart valve to the holder device involves coupling the second frame to the plurality of arms.
18. The method of claim 16, further comprising: withdrawing the prosthetic heart valve from the holder device.
19. The method of claim 16, further comprising folding a portion of the second fibrous covering over an inflow edge of the prosthetic heart valve.
20. The method of claim 16, wherein the holder device comprises a spacer form.
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